

# CLAT Express - April 2026: Study Notes

Chapters, topics and sub-topics with key facts, memory aids and mind-map outlines.

## International Relations and News

### Visit of Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan to Sri Lanka

#### Bilateral Ties and Cooperation Areas

Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan made the first-ever bilateral visit to Sri Lanka and held talks with President Anura Kumara Dissanayake in Colombo. The visit highlighted trade, development, defence and development-linked cooperation between India and Sri Lanka. India is Sri Lanka's largest trade partner and largest source of tourists.

- First-ever bilateral visit to Sri Lanka by the Vice President
- Talks with President Anura Kumara Dissanayake held in Colombo
- India is Sri Lanka's largest trade partner and largest source of tourists
- India-Sri Lanka FTA was signed in 2000
- India supports development of Trincomalee as a Regional Energy and Industrial Hub
- India and Sri Lanka jointly commission a Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre
- Construction of Sampur Solar Power Plant in Sri Lanka
- Joint exercises: SLINEX (Naval), MITRA SHAKTI (Army), MILAN (Multi-Lateral Naval)
- MoUs under Multi-Sectoral Grant Assistance Programme focus on healthcare and women's empowerment
- Sri Lanka joins the International Big Cat Alliance

Mind-map outline

Bilateral Ties

- Trade and tourism
  - Largest trade partner
  - Largest tourist source
  - FTA signed in 2000
- Development
  - Trincomalee energy hub
  - Maritime Rescue Coordination Centre
  - Sampur solar plant
- Joint exercises
  - SLINEX: naval
  - MITRA SHAKTI: army
  - MILAN: multi-lateral naval

#### Diaspora Schemes: PIO and OCI

The OCI scheme was introduced in 2005 through an amendment to the Citizenship Act, 1955, and was merged with the PIO scheme in 2015. PIO card holders need no visa to visit India for 15 years from the date of issue of the card. OCI holders get a multipurpose, multiple-entry, lifelong visa and are exempt from police reporting.

- OCI scheme introduced in 2005 via amendment to the Citizenship Act, 1955
- PIO and OCI schemes merged in 2015
- PIO: a foreign citizen, except nationals of Pakistan, Afghanistan, Bangladesh, China, Iran, Bhutan, Sri Lanka and Nepal
- PIO: a parent, grandparent or great-grandparent was born in and a permanent resident of India, or the person is a spouse of an Indian citizen or PIO
- PIO card holders need no visa for 15 years from the date of issue of the card
- PIO stay up to 180 days is exempt from FRRO/FRO registration; longer stays must register within 30 days
- OCI eligibility covers persons eligible for Indian citizenship on 26.01.1950 and their minor children
- Persons who were ever citizens of Pakistan or Bangladesh are not eligible for OCI
- OCI holders get a multipurpose, multiple-entry, lifelong visa and are exempt from police reporting

- OCI holders have no right to acquire agricultural or plantation properties

Mnemonic - OCI benefits: Many Mango Lovers Exempt

Many = Multipurpose visa; Mango = Multiple-entry visa; Lovers = Lifelong visa; Exempt = Exempt from police reporting

Mind-map outline

Diaspora Schemes

- PIO scheme
  - No visa for 15 years
  - 180-day registration exemption
  - Parity with NRIs
- OCI scheme
  - Introduced 2005
  - Lifelong multiple-entry visa
  - No agricultural property rights

## Katchatheevu Island Dispute

Katchatheevu is an uninhabited 285-acre island in the Palk Strait, and its ownership remained disputed until 1974. Sri Lanka based its claim on early medieval rule and Portuguese jurisdiction, while India's claim traced control through the Ramnad Zamindari under the Nayak dynasty of Madurai. Tensions over Indian fishermen after the 2009 Sri Lanka Civil War have renewed demands over the island.

- Katchatheevu is an uninhabited 285-acre island located in the Palk Strait
- The island was once part of the Madras Presidency
- Ownership remained a point of dispute between India and Sri Lanka until 1974
- Sri Lanka's claim: Jaffna Kingdom ruled the island in the early medieval period
- Sri Lanka's claim: Portuguese (1505-1658 CE) exercised jurisdiction over the islet
- India's claim: control later shifted to the Ramnad Zamindari under the Nayak dynasty of Madurai in the 17th century
- Indo-Sri Lankan Maritime Agreement 1974, under Indira Gandhi, agreed to cede the island to Sri Lanka
- The 1974 agreement allowed Indian fishermen continued access to Katchatheevu
- Additional Agreement of 1976 barred fishing by both countries in each other's EEZ, with the island at the boundary
- After the 2009 Sri Lanka Civil War, arrests and torture allegations of Indian fishermen renewed Katchatheevu demands

Mnemonic - Katchatheevu claimants in order: Just Pack Nicely

Just = Jaffna Kingdom ruled the island in the early medieval period; Pack = Portuguese jurisdiction over the islet, 1505-1658 CE; Nicely = Nayak dynasty control in the 17th century

Mind-map outline

Katchatheevu

- Claims
  - Sri Lanka: Jaffna Kingdom
  - Sri Lanka: Portuguese jurisdiction
  - India: Nayak dynasty control
- Agreements
  - 1974: ceded to Sri Lanka
  - 1974: fishermen access continued
  - 1976: no fishing in each other's EEZ
- Recent tensions
  - Arrests and torture allegations

## Sri Lanka Profile and Strategic Context

Colombo is the executive capital of Sri Lanka and Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte houses the legislature, with Harini Amarasuriya as Prime Minister and Anura Kumara Disanayake as President. The LTTE, formed in 1976, and the 13th Amendment shape Sri Lanka's internal politics. China's growing presence through financial aid and Hambantota Port raises strategic concerns for India.

- Capital: Colombo (Executive) and Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte (Legislature)
- PM: Harini Amarasuriya; President: Anura Kumara Disanayake
- Currency: Sri Lankan Rupee
- LTTE was formed in 1976 as a self-styled 'National Freedom Movement of People of Tamil Eelam'
- LTTE undertook terrorist activities in Sri Lanka, especially against Sinhalese
- 13th Amendment of the Sri Lankan Constitution led to Provincial Councils with power-sharing for all 9 provinces
- China's influence grows through financial aid and Hambantota Port
- Chinese vessels Shi Yan-6 and Yuan Wang-5 conduct data collection, potentially supporting military operations against India
- Multilateral forums include BIMSTEC, SAARC, Colombo Security Conclave and Indian Ocean Rim Association

Mind-map outline

Sri Lanka Context

- Politics
  - Colombo: executive capital
  - Kotte: legislature
  - 13th Amendment: provincial councils
- Security
  - LTTE formed 1976
  - China: Hambantota Port
  - Chinese vessels collect data

## National News and Issues

### Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026

#### Bill and Lok Sabha expansion

The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 was proposed along with the Delimitation Bill, 2026 to restructure representation. It would expand the Lok Sabha from 543 to 850 seats, with 815 for States and 35 for Union Territories. Seat allocation and delimitation would use the 2011 Census, and Parliament would decide which population data to use.

- Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026 proposed with the Delimitation Bill, 2026
- Lok Sabha to expand from 543 to 850 seats
- Proposed 850 seats: 815 for States and 35 for Union Territories
- Current Lok Sabha strength: 543 elected members
- 2011 Census used for seat allocation and delimitation
- Article 82 amended to lift the freeze on redrawing constituency boundaries
- Parliament empowered to decide which population data to use
- Current Lok Sabha seat freeze is based on the 1971 Census under the 84th Amendment

Mind-map outline

Lok Sabha expansion

- Current strength: 543 elected members
- Proposed strength: 850 seats
- Split: 815 States, 35 UTs
- Population base: 2011 Census

## Women's reservation

The Bill overrides the delay linked to the Census for women's reservation under the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam. Reservation is for one-third of seats in the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies, valid for 15 years and extendable by Parliament. Reserved constituencies rotate after each delimitation, and the reservation does not extend to the Rajya Sabha or State Legislative Councils.

- Women's Reservation Act, 2023 is the 106th Constitutional Amendment Act
- One-third of total seats in Lok Sabha and State Assemblies reserved for women
- Article 330A: reservation for women in the Lok Sabha
- Article 332A: reservation for women in State Legislative Assemblies
- Article 239AA: reservation for women in the NCT of Delhi
- Article 334A: reservation effective after delimitation and Census
- Reservation valid for 15 years and can be extended
- Reserved seats rotate after each delimitation
- Within SC/ST reserved seats, one-third reserved for SC/ST women under the Bill
- Women's reservation bills were introduced in 1996, 1998, 2009, 2010 and 2014
- No women's reservation in the Rajya Sabha or State Legislative Councils

Mnemonic - Women's reservation terms: Three Fifteen Rotate

Three = One-third of total seats in Lok Sabha and State Assemblies reserved for women; Fifteen = Reservation valid for 15 years, extendable by Parliament; Rotate = Reserved constituencies rotate after each delimitation

Mind-map outline

Women's reservation

- Seats: one-third in LS and State LAs
  - 330A: Lok Sabha
  - 332A: State Assemblies
  - 239AA: NCT of Delhi
  - 334A: effective after delimitation and Census
- Duration: 15 years, extendable
- Rotation after each delimitation
- Not covered: Rajya Sabha, State Councils

## Delimitation and the Commission

Delimitation redraws territorial constituency boundaries so that representation stays fair after population changes. Article 82 requires Parliament to pass a Delimitation Act after every Census, and the President appoints the Delimitation Commission. The Delimitation Bill, 2026 gives the Commission civil court powers and states that its orders cannot be challenged in courts.

- Delimitation defines territorial constituency boundaries after population changes
- Article 82: Parliament to pass a Delimitation Act after every Census
- Article 170 governs the division of constituencies for State Assemblies
- President appoints the Delimitation Commission in consultation with the Election Commission
- Commission members: a retired Supreme Court judge (Chairperson), the Chief Election Commissioner and State Election Commissioners
- Commission decisions are final and not subject to court review or modification by Parliament or State Assemblies
- Delimitation Commissions were formed under Acts of 1952, 1962, 1972 and 2002
- No Commission was formed after the 1981 and 1991 Censuses
- 84th Amendment (2002) extended the freeze until the first Census after 2026

Mind-map outline

Delimitation

- Article 82: Delimitation Act after each Census
- Article 170: State Assembly constituencies
- Commission appointed by the President
  - Retired SC judge chairs
  - CEC and State Election Commissioners
- Decisions final, not subject to court review

## Concerns and consequences

Critics point to federal imbalance, with the South's share of Lok Sabha seats projected to fall from 24.3% to about 20.7%. Concerns also include outdated 2011 data, removal of judicial review and excess legislative control over delimitation. Supporters point to smaller constituencies, better grievance redressal and a more efficient use of MPLADS funds.

- Federal imbalance: Southern States' share falls from 24.3% to about 20.7%
- Northern dominance: high population growth states gain more seats
- Outdated data: the 2011 Census may distort representation for decades
- Judicial review removed: risk of gerrymandering
- Excess legislative control: Parliament's discretion may politicise delimitation
- Ministers capped at 15% of Lok Sabha strength under Article 75(1A)
- Joint sittings: Lok Sabha dominance dilutes the Rajya Sabha's federal role
- Expansion reduces constituency size and improves accessibility and grievance redressal
- Census dependency delays implementation of women's reservation

Mnemonic - Five key concerns: Fine Nations Often Judge Earnestly

F = Federal imbalance: South's share falls from 24.3% to about 20.7%; N = Northern dominance: high population growth states gain more seats; O = Outdated data: 2011 Census may distort representation; J = Judicial review removed: risk of gerrymandering; E = Excess legislative control: Parliament's discretion may politicise delimitation

Mind-map outline

Concerns

- Federal imbalance
  - Southern share 24.3% to about 20.7%
  - High-growth states gain seats
- Governance
  - Ministers capped at 15% (Art 75(1A))
  - Weaker Rajya Sabha in joint sittings
- Oversight
  - Judicial review removed
  - Excess legislative control

## World's Largest Digital Census Begins: Census 2027 (Phase 1)

### Census 2027 Phase I and digital enumeration

India has launched Phase I of Census 2027, described as the world's largest population count and the first fully digital enumeration exercise. Phase I is a House Listing and Housing Census, with self-enumeration from 1 April 2026 and a field exercise from 16 April to 15 May 2026 in notified States and UTs. The exercise relies on mobile applications, web-based data collection and digital mapping tools.

- Phase I of Census 2027 is a House Listing and Housing Census.
- Self-enumeration began on 1 April 2026.
- Field exercise runs from 16 April to 15 May 2026 in notified States and UTs.
- Key focus areas: housing conditions, household amenities, assets and infrastructure.
- Described as the first fully digital census exercise in India.
- Digital tools: mobile applications, web-based data collection and digital mapping tools.
- Self-enumeration works through a secure web portal and is available in 16 languages.
- Stated limitation: only residents currently present in India are covered.
- The Census 2027 questionnaire contains 33 questions.

Mind-map outline

Census 2027 Phase I

- Focus areas
  - Housing conditions
  - Household amenities
  - Assets and infrastructure
- Timeline
  - Self-enumeration from 1 April 2026

- Field exercise 16 April to 15 May 2026
- Digital features
  - Mobile applications
  - Web-based data collection
  - Digital mapping tools
- Self-enumeration
  - Secure web portal
  - 16 languages
  - Residents present in India only

## Census history and caste enumeration

Population counts are traced to the Arthashastra, Ain-e-Akbari and Rig Veda. The modern census developed in the colonial period, with a non-synchronous national census in 1871 and a synchronous census in 1881. The 1931 census was the last caste-based census, and after Independence only SC and ST data has been collected.

- Ancient references to population counts appear in the Arthashastra, Ain-e-Akbari and Rig Veda.
- The 1871 national census was non-synchronous and was conducted under Lord Mayo.
- The 1881 synchronous census was conducted by WC Plowden under Lord Rippon.
- JH Hutton was Census Commissioner in 1931; RA Gopalaswami was Census Commissioner in 1951.
- The 1931 census was the last caste-based census.
- After 1947 only SC and ST data was collected; OBCs have been excluded until now.
- The 1921 census is the only census to witness a decadal population decline.
- Bihar, Karnataka and Telangana undertook independent caste surveys, in that order.
- India has held 7 censuses since Independence.

Mnemonic - Census landmarks: Mayo 71, Rippon 81, Last Caste 31

Mayo 71 = 1871 non-synchronous national census under Lord Mayo; Rippon 81 = 1881 synchronous census under Lord Rippon; Last Caste 31 = 1931 was the last caste-based census

Mind-map outline

Census history

- Ancient references
  - Arthashastra
  - Ain-e-Akbari
  - Rig Veda
- Colonial censuses
  - 1871 non-synchronous (Lord Mayo)
  - 1881 synchronous (WC Plowden)
  - 1931 last caste-based census
- Post-Independence
  - Only SC and ST data collected
  - OBCs excluded until now
  - 7 censuses since Independence
- Recent caste surveys
  - Bihar, Karnataka, Telangana
  - Independent state surveys

## Constitutional and legal framework

The Union's power to conduct the census rests on Article 246 and Entry 69 of the Union List. The Census Act, 1948 provides the legal mandate and makes participation mandatory. The 84th Constitutional Amendment Act of 2002 froze Lok Sabha seat allocation on 1971 Census data until the first census conducted after 2026.

- The Union has the power to conduct the census under Article 246 and Entry 69 of the Union List.
- Articles 81 and 82 relate to Lok Sabha seat distribution and delimitation after 2026.
- The 84th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002 froze Lok Sabha seat allocation using 1971 Census data.
- The freeze lasts until the first census conducted after 2026.
- The Census Act, 1948 provides the legal mandate and makes participation mandatory.

- The census is managed by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India, Mritunjay Kumar Narayan.

Mind-map outline

Legal framework

- Power to conduct census
  - Article 246
  - Entry 69, Union List
- Census Act, 1948
  - Legal mandate
  - Participation mandatory
- Delimitation links
  - Articles 81 and 82
  - 84th Amendment, 2002
  - Seat allocation frozen on 1971 data
- Management
  - Registrar General and Census Commissioner
  - Mritunjay Kumar Narayan

### **Purpose of the census and its challenges**

Census data supports delimitation, women's one-third seat reservation and planning for healthcare, education and infrastructure. Unlike sample surveys, the census offers comprehensive population data. Challenges include limited rural digital access, caste data inconsistencies, logistics, public trust and administrative capacity.

- Caste data is seen as key to sharpen welfare schemes such as PM Awas Yojana and Skill India.
- Caste data aids delimitation and enables Women's One-Third Seat Reservation in Parliament and Assemblies.
- Unlike sample surveys, the census offers comprehensive population data.
- Demographic data is vital for planning healthcare, education and infrastructure.
- Census forms are the basis for updating the National Population Register.
- Challenge: limited rural access to digital tools.
- Challenge: avoid duplication and inconsistencies in caste data.
- Challenge: large-scale training and coverage of remote areas.
- Challenge: public trust, given fears around NPR/NRC linkages.
- Challenge: administrative capacity, covering funds, staffing and inter-agency coordination.

Mnemonic - Five census challenges: Tigers Dance, Lions Perform Admirably

T = Technological: limited rural access to digital tools; D = Data classification: avoid duplication and inconsistencies in caste data; L = Logistical: large-scale training and coverage of remote areas; P = Public trust: fears around NPR/NRC linkages; A = Administrative capacity: funds, staffing and inter-agency coordination

Mind-map outline

Purpose and challenges

- Purpose
  - Caste data for delimitation
  - Women's one-third seat reservation
  - Benchmark beyond sample surveys
  - Planning healthcare, education, infrastructure
- Challenges
  - Technological: rural digital access
  - Data classification: caste duplication
  - Logistical: training and remote areas
  - Public trust: NPR/NRC fears
  - Administrative capacity: funds, staffing

## **NPR, CAA and NRC compared**

The NPR is a nationwide database of every resident, including foreigners, meant for government schemes. The CAA covers minority refugees from Pakistan, Afghanistan and Bangladesh who came to India before 31 December 2014. The NRC covers citizens of India with valid identity documents, and only Assam currently updates it.

- NPR is a database of every resident, including foreigners.
- NPR covers residents who have lived at an address for the last 6 months and will stay there for the next 6 months.
- NPR is meant to be used for government schemes and has nationwide coverage.
- CAA covers minority refugees (Hindu, Christian, Sikh, Parsi, Jain, Buddhist) from Pakistan, Afghanistan and Bangladesh.
- CAA covers those minority refugees who came to India before 31 December 2014.
- NRC covers citizens of India with valid identity documents.
- Currently, only Assam updates the NRC.
- Government's answer: there is no duplication between NPR and Aadhaar, as the objectives are different.
- Government's answer: Muslims are not a minority in the 3 neighbouring countries, so they are not mentioned.

Mind-map outline

NPR, CAA and NRC

- NPR
  - Every resident, including foreigners
  - Lived 6 months, staying 6 more
  - Used for government schemes
- CAA
  - Minority refugees from three countries
  - Came before 31 December 2014
  - Hindu, Christian, Sikh, Parsi, Jain, Buddhist
- NRC
  - Citizens with valid identity documents
  - Only Assam updates NRC

## **India Declared Naxal-Free**

### **Origins, Ideology and Causes of LWE**

Left Wing Extremism (LWE) traces back to a 1967 uprising in Naxalbari, West Bengal, and aims at societal and political change through revolutionary methods. Its ideology seeks to overthrow the central government through armed revolution and to set up a communist state based on Maoist principles. The booklet links the movement's growth to tribal displacement, tribal resentment over forest laws, poverty and weak governance.

- Originated in the 1967 uprising in Naxalbari, West Bengal
- Aim: societal and political change through revolutionary methods
- Ideology: overthrow the central government through armed revolution
- Methods include violence and guerrilla warfare
- Goal: establish a communist state based on Maoist principles
- Massive displacement of tribal population due to development projects and mining operations
- Forest (Conservation) Act 1980 prohibits tribes from harvesting forest resources
- Poverty and lack of sustainable means drive people to join the Naxalite movement
- Lack of effective governance is a listed factor responsible for the movement
- Insufficient technical intelligence against Naxalism is a listed factor responsible for the movement

Mnemonic - Causes of LWE: Displaced Tribals Poorly Governed

D = Massive displacement of tribal population by development projects and mining; T = Tribal dissatisfaction with the Forest (Conservation) Act 1980; P = Poverty and lack of sustainable means; G = Lack of effective governance

Mind-map outline

LWE: origins, ideology and causes

- Origin and aim
  - 1967 uprising in Naxalbari, West Bengal
  - Aim: revolutionary societal and political change
- Ideology
  - Overthrow central government by armed revolution
  - Communist state on Maoist principles
- Causes
  - Tribal displacement by projects and mining
  - Forest (Conservation) Act 1980 restrictions
  - Poverty and lack of sustainable means
  - Weak governance and technical intelligence gaps

### **Current LWE Landscape and Factors Behind the Decline**

The booklet reports a sharp fall in LWE-affected districts, from 126 in 2014 to about 7 in 2026, with the remaining hotspots in Chhattisgarh. Violence fell as well, with incidents down 88% and deaths down 90% between 2010 and 2025. The measures credited for this include tactical operations, road and mobile connectivity, action against funding networks, surrender incentives and administrative expansion.

- LWE-affected districts reduced from 126 (2014) to about 7 (2026)
- Residual hotspots: Bijapur, Sukma and Narayanpur in Chhattisgarh
- Incidents of violence down 88%: 1,936 in 2010 to 234 in 2025
- Deaths down 90%: 1,005 in 2010
- Red Corridor: severe Naxalism-Maoist insurgency across ten listed states, including Kerala and Telangana
- Tactical dominance by COBRA and Greyhounds, using company operating bases to penetrate remote zones
- Infrastructure integration: 12,000 km of all-weather roads reduced geographical isolation of insurgents
- Information warfare: 9,000+ mobile (4G) towers countered Maoist propaganda and integrated tribal regions digitally
- Financial crackdown: NIA and Enforcement Directorate action and asset seizures disrupted urban funding networks
- Surrender-cum-Rehabilitation Policy: 10,000+ cadres surrendered since 2014, with cash benefits and skill training

Mind-map outline

Current LWE landscape and decline

- Decline indicators
  - Districts: 126 (2014) to about 7 (2026)
  - Incidents down 88%, 2010 to 2025
  - Deaths down 90%, 2010 to 2025
- Security and tactics
  - COBRA and Greyhounds
  - Company operating bases in remote zones
- Connectivity
  - 12,000 km all-weather roads
  - 9,000+ mobile (4G) towers
- Funding and cadres
  - Asset seizures disrupt urban funding
  - 10,000+ cadres surrendered since 2014
- Governance
  - Eklavya Model Residential Schools
  - Aspirational Districts Programme
  - Unified command structure

## Government Initiatives: Policy, SAMADHAN and Tribal Development

The government's response combines a 2015 national policy and action plan with the SAMADHAN doctrine, a set of eight elements running from leadership to financing. Parallel development schemes target tribal regions, including the Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan and PM-JANMAN. The booklet also cites the 2006 Bandyopadhyay Committee, which highlighted governance and discrimination gaps faced by tribals.

- National Policy and Action Plan to address Left Wing Extremism, 2015
- SAMADHAN doctrine: Smart leadership, Aggressive strategy, Motivation and training, Actionable intelligence
- SAMADHAN also covers Dashboard based KPIs and KRAs, Harnessing technology, Action plan for each theatre and No access to financing
- Special Central Assistance (SCA) supports public infrastructure and services
- Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan covers 63,000+ tribal villages, with focus on housing and water
- PM-JANMAN targets 75 PVTGs for basic infrastructure and healthcare in remote habitations
- Van Dhan Vikas Kendra: 2,200+ clusters promote minor forest produce value addition
- Bastariya Battalion: local recruits in Chhattisgarh who know the language and terrain
- Bandyopadhyay Committee (2006) highlighted lack of governance and socio-political and cultural discrimination against tribals
- Bandyopadhyay Committee recommended tribal-friendly land acquisition and rehabilitation

Mnemonic - SAMADHAN Doctrine: Smart Aims Mean Actionable Dashboards Harnessing Action, No Financing

S = Smart leadership; A = Aggressive strategy; M = Motivation and training; A = Actionable intelligence; D = Dashboard based KPIs and KRAs; H = Harnessing technology; A = Action plan for each theatre; N = No access to financing

Mind-map outline

Government initiatives against LWE

- Policy framework
  - National Policy and Action Plan, 2015
  - Bandyopadhyay Committee, 2006
- SAMADHAN doctrine
  - Smart leadership
  - Aggressive strategy
  - Motivation and training
  - Actionable intelligence
  - Dashboard based KPIs and KRAs
  - Harnessing technology
  - Action plan for each theatre
  - No access to financing
- Tribal development schemes
  - Dharti Aaba: 63,000+ tribal villages
  - PM-JANMAN: 75 PVTGs
  - Van Dhan Vikas Kendra: 2,200+ clusters
- Forces
  - Greyhounds in Andhra Pradesh
  - Bastariya Battalion in Chhattisgarh

## Polity and Governance

### Gujarat Passed Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026

#### Key Features of Gujarat UCC

Gujarat passed the Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026, becoming the second state after Uttarakhand to enact a UCC. The Bill creates a uniform civil framework that replaces diverse religious personal laws on marriage, divorce and inheritance. It also sets registration deadlines, bans polygamy and bigamy, and routes separations through civil courts.

- Gujarat is the second state to enact a UCC, after Uttarakhand.

- Uniform civil framework replaces diverse religious personal laws on marriage, divorce and inheritance.
- Gender equality: equal inheritance rights for sons and daughters.
- Marriage must be registered within 60 days.
- Live-in relationships must be registered within 30 days.
- Monogamy rule prohibits polygamy and bigamy.
- All separations must be processed through civil courts (judicial exclusivity in divorce).
- Scheduled Tribes are excluded to preserve their customary practices and cultural identity.

Mnemonic - Registration Deadlines: Marriage gets sixty, live-in gets thirty  
60 days = Marriage must be registered within 60 days; 30 days = Live-in relationships must be registered within 30 days

Mind-map outline

Gujarat UCC provisions

- Marriage and family
  - Marriage registration: 60 days
  - Live-in registration: 30 days
  - Monogamy: polygamy and bigamy barred
- Divorce and inheritance
  - Separations: civil courts
  - Equal inheritance: sons and daughters
- Exemption
  - Scheduled Tribes excluded
  - Protects customary practices

## Background and Constitutional Basis

The need for a uniform law was first considered in the Lex Loci Report of 1840, and the colonial government formed the B N Rau Committee in 1941 to examine common Hindu laws. Article 44 urges the state to establish a UCC, but it is part of the non-enforceable DPSP. Personal laws on marriage, divorce and succession sit in the Concurrent List, so both Parliament and state legislatures can legislate on them.

- Lex Loci Report of 1840 first considered the need for a uniform law.
- Colonial government formed the B N Rau Committee in 1941.
- B N Rau Committee examined the necessity of common Hindu laws and recommended a codified Hindu law giving equal rights to women.
- Hindu Succession Act, 1956 codified intestate succession among Hindus, Buddhists, Jains and Sikhs.
- Dr. B. R. Ambedkar was chosen by Nehru in 1948 to chair the sub-committee developing the Hindu Code Bill.
- Four Hindu Code Bills: Hindu Marriage Act 1955; Hindu Succession, Hindu Minority and Guardianship, and Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Acts 1956.
- Underlying principle of UCC: laws should be gender-neutral and religion-neutral.
- Article 44 urges the state to establish a uniform civil code; it is part of the DPSP and is not enforceable.
- Personal laws on marriage, divorce and succession are under the Concurrent List.

Mnemonic - Four Hindu Code Bills: Mighty Saints Mostly Adore

M = Hindu Marriage Act, 1955; S = Hindu Succession Act, 1956; M = Hindu Minority and Guardianship Act, 1956; A = Hindu Adoptions and Maintenance Act, 1956

Mind-map outline

Background and basis

- Historical milestones
  - Lex Loci Report: 1840
  - B N Rau Committee: 1941
  - Hindu Succession Act: 1956
- Constitutional position
  - Article 44: DPSP
  - Not enforceable
  - Concurrent List

## Views, Courts and Landmark Cases

Views on UCC differ across the Law Commissions, the Central Government, the Constitution's framers and the Supreme Court. The 21st Law Commission found a UCC neither necessary nor desirable in 2018, while the Central Government favours one. Landmark judgments such as Shah Bano, Sarla Mudgal, Shayara Bano and Jose Paulo Coutinho have shaped the debate.

- 21st Law Commission (2018) found a UCC neither necessary nor desirable at this stage and recommended reforming family laws across religions.
- Framers of the Constitution did not intend total uniformity and placed personal laws in the Concurrent List.
- Central Government favours a UCC and calls different property and matrimonial laws a threat to national unity.
- Supreme Court has called for implementing the UCC in many cases.
- Shah Bano Begum case (1985): maintenance under Section 125 CrPC even after the iddat period.
- Sarla Mudgal case (1995): a Hindu husband cannot convert to Islam and remarry without dissolving his first marriage.
- Shayara Bano case (2017): triple talaq declared unconstitutional; Parliament urged to regulate Muslim marriages and divorces.
- Indian Young Lawyers Association case (2018): personal and customary law falls under Article 13.
- Jose Paulo Coutinho case (2019): Goa hailed as a 'shining example' of a UCC.
- 22nd Law Commission issued a notification seeking views on UCC.

Mind-map outline

Views and landmark cases

- Official views
  - 21st Law Commission: unnecessary, 2018
  - Central Government: favours UCC
  - Framers: no total uniformity
- Landmark cases
  - Shah Bano: 1985
  - Sarla Mudgal: 1995
  - Shayara Bano: 2017
  - Jose Paulo Coutinho: 2019

## Arguments For and Against the UCC

The UCC is presented as a way to promote gender equality, eliminate discriminatory practices against women, align with India's secular nature and reform outdated, regressive practices. Critics argue that it conflicts with the right to freedom of religion under Articles 25-28, that some civil laws are inseparably linked to religious beliefs, and that it could be politically exploited and lead to social unrest.

- Objective: promote gender equality.
- Objective: eliminate discriminatory practices against women.
- Objective: align with the secular nature of the Indian state.
- Objective: reform outdated and regressive practices.
- Concern: UCC is seen as against the right to freedom of religion guaranteed under Articles 25-28.
- Concern: some civil laws are inseparably connected with religious beliefs and practices.
- Concern: implementation could be politically exploited, leading to social unrest.
- Concern: a UCC might not accommodate the unique customs and sensitivities of different communities.

Mnemonic - Objectives of the UCC: Good Dads Share Rules

G = Promote gender equality; D = Eliminate discriminatory practices against women; S = Align with the secular nature of the state; R = Reform outdated and regressive practices

Mind-map outline

UCC debate

- For: objectives
  - Gender equality
  - Eliminate discrimination against women
  - Secular nature alignment

- Reform regressive practices
- Against: concerns
  - Freedom of religion, Articles 25-28
  - Civil laws tied to religion
  - Political exploitation
  - Risk of social unrest

## **Mahanadi Water Dispute**

### **Dispute background and positions**

The Mahanadi dispute concerns how the river's waters are shared between upstream Chhattisgarh and downstream Odisha. Odisha says upstream construction has reduced its downstream flow, while Chhattisgarh cites its larger catchment share and development needs. The conflict is sharpest in the non-monsoon season and is intensified by the absence of a formal sharing agreement.

- Dispute escalated around 2016 after increased upstream infrastructure development
- Odisha approached the Supreme Court of India, which led to a tribunal being constituted
- Odisha argues that upstream constructions by Chhattisgarh reduced downstream water flow
- Odisha's concerns: irrigation, drinking water supply, fisheries and ecological sustainability
- Chhattisgarh says it accounts for a larger share of the basin's catchment area
- Chhattisgarh says its projects are necessary for regional development and water security
- Dispute is most critical in the non-monsoon season when downstream water availability matters most
- Absence of a formal inter-state water-sharing agreement has intensified the conflict

Mind-map outline

Dispute background and positions

- Escalation
  - Around 2016
  - Upstream infrastructure growth
- Odisha's concerns
  - Decline in downstream flow
  - Irrigation, drinking water, fisheries
- Chhattisgarh's position
  - Larger catchment share
  - Development and water security
- Key gaps
  - No formal sharing agreement
  - Non-monsoon season is critical

### **Tribunal status and deadlock**

The Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal has given both states a final opportunity to agree a water-sharing formula and has issued an ultimatum for a settlement by May 2. If no settlement is reached, the Tribunal will decide on available evidence and legal principles. The Tribunal has voiced dissatisfaction with repeated adjournments, and the deadlock is linked to unreliable data and a trust deficit.

- Tribunal granted both states a Final Opportunity to agree a mutually agreed water-sharing formula
- Final ultimatum: present a water-sharing settlement to the Tribunal by May 2
- If the states fail, the Tribunal will adjudicate on available evidence and legal principles
- Tribunal will deliver a Final Judgment on Merits if Odisha and Chhattisgarh fail to settle
- Tribunal is dissatisfied with repeated adjournments and lack of substantive progress
- No concrete proposals or narrowing of contentious issues have been placed on record
- Deadlock is attributed to absence of reliable and mutually accepted hydrological data
- A persistent trust deficit between the two states has hindered negotiation and consensus

Mind-map outline

Tribunal status and deadlock

- Tribunal stance
  - Final opportunity for states

- Adjudicate on evidence if no deal
- Court's dissatisfaction
  - Repeated adjournments
  - No concrete proposals on record
- Deadlock reasons
  - Unreliable hydrological data
  - Persistent trust deficit

## Legal framework for inter-state waters

Article 262 empowers Parliament to adjudicate inter-state river disputes and allows it to exclude courts' jurisdiction in such matters. The Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956 was used for the Mahanadi tribunal, and the River Boards Act, 1956 provides for river boards. Entries 17 and 56 divide powers between the States and the Union, and the Supreme Court cannot question a tribunal's award but can question its working.

- Article 262 empowers Parliament to adjudicate disputes relating to inter-state rivers
- Article 262 empowers Parliament to adjudicate disputes relating to inter-State rivers
- Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956 was used to constitute the Mahanadi tribunal
- Centre first tries consultation among aggrieved states; if that fails it may constitute a tribunal
- River Boards Act, 1956 lets the Centre establish boards for inter-state rivers in consultation with states
- A River Board is to meet at least thrice a year and the Prime Minister is its Chairman
- No River Board has been created to date
- Entry 17 (State List) covers water supplies, irrigation, canals, drainage and embankments
- Entry 56 (Union List) empowers the Union to regulate and develop inter-state rivers in public interest
- Supreme Court cannot question a tribunal's award or formula but can question its working

Mnemonic - State List vs Union List: Seventeen stays with States, Fifty-six goes to the Union

17 = Entry 17 of the State List covers water supplies, irrigation, canals, drainage and embankments; 56 = Entry 56 of the Union List lets the Union regulate and develop inter-state rivers in public interest

Mind-map outline

Legal framework

- Constitution
  - Article 262: Parliament adjudicates
  - Courts' jurisdiction may be excluded
- Statutes
  - Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956
  - River Boards Act, 1956
- Lists
  - Entry 17: State List
  - Entry 56: Union List

## River course and Hirakud Dam

The Mahanadi originates at Sihawa Hill in Raipur, Chhattisgarh, and flows through Odisha before emptying into the Bay of Bengal. It receives left-bank and right-bank tributaries. Hirakud Dam on the river is described in the booklet as the longest earthen dam in the world.

- Mahanadi originates at Sihawa Hill in Raipur, Chhattisgarh
- Mahanadi flows through Odisha before emptying into the Bay of Bengal
- Left bank tributaries: Shivnath, Hasdeo, Mand and Ib
- Right bank tributaries: Jonk, Ong and Tel
- Hirakud Dam is the longest earthen dam in the world

Mnemonic - Left bank tributaries: Some Hungry Monkeys Itch

S = Shivnath, a left bank tributary of the Mahanadi; H = Hasdeo, a left bank tributary of the Mahanadi;

M = Mand, a left bank tributary of the Mahanadi; I = Ib, a left bank tributary of the Mahanadi

Mind-map outline

Mahanadi river course

- Origin

- Sihawa Hill, Raipur
- Flow
  - Through Odisha
  - Mouth: Bay of Bengal
- Left bank tributaries
  - Shivnath, Hasdeo, Mand, Ib
- Right bank tributaries
  - Jonk, Ong, Tel
- Infrastructure
  - Hirakud Dam

### Other inter-state water tribunals

India has several inter-state water tribunals, each set up for a particular river dispute. The booklet lists tribunals formed between 1986 and 2018, covering states such as Punjab, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha. The Mahanadi tribunal is one of these five.

- Ravi & Beas Water Tribunal, formed 1986: Rajasthan, Haryana and Punjab
- Krishna Water Disputes Tribunal II, formed 2004: Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, Telangana and Karnataka
- Mahadayi Water Disputes Tribunal, formed 2010: Karnataka, Goa and Maharashtra
- Vansadhara Water Disputes Tribunal, formed 2010: Odisha and Andhra Pradesh
- Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal, formed 2018: Chhattisgarh and Odisha

Mind-map outline

Other inter-state water tribunals

- Ravi & Beas (1986)
  - Rajasthan, Haryana, Punjab
- Krishna II (2004)
  - AP, Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka
- Mahadayi (2010)
  - Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra
- Vansadhara (2010)
  - Odisha, Andhra Pradesh
- Mahanadi (2018)
  - Chhattisgarh, Odisha

## National Panchayati Raj Day 2026

### Event details and key highlights

The 17th National Panchayati Raj Day was observed on 24 April at Vigyan Bhawan, organised by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj. The theme was Sashakt Panchayat, Sarvangeen Vikas. The day marks the enforcement of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment and highlights initiatives such as the National Panchayat Awards and the Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0.

- The 17th National Panchayati Raj Day was observed on 24 April.
- The event was held at Vigyan Bhawan.
- It was organised by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj.
- Theme: Sashakt Panchayat, Sarvangeen Vikas.
- The day marks enforcement of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment, aimed at grassroots democracy and decentralised governance.
- National Panchayat Awards recognise best-performing panchayats.
- Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0 measures grassroots development and tracks panchayat performance.
- e-GramSwaraj is used for transparent monitoring and data-driven governance.
- Panchayat Dharohar Initiative is one of the key highlights.

Mind-map outline

National Panchayati Raj Day 2026

- Event details
  - 17th edition on 24 April
  - Venue: Vigyan Bhawan

- Organiser: Ministry of Panchayati Raj
- Theme
  - Sashakt Panchayat, Sarvangeen Vikas
- Initiatives
  - Panchayat Dharohar Initiative
  - National Panchayat Awards
  - Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0
  - e-GramSwaraj

## Committees on Panchayati Raj (1957-1986)

Several committees shaped the idea of Panchayati Raj before it was given constitutional form. The Balwant Rai Mehta Committee recommended democratic decentralisation, and Rajasthan became the first state to establish Panchayati Raj, at Nagaur, on 2 October 1959. Later committees under Ashok Mehta, G.V.K. Rao and L.M. Singhvi reviewed the system: the Ashok Mehta committee recommended a two-tier system, the G.V.K. Rao committee reviewed administrative arrangements for rural development and poverty alleviation programmes, and the Singhvi committee recommended constitutional recognition of panchayats.

- The Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957) examined the Community Development Programme (1952) and the National Extension Service (1953).
- The Balwant Rai Mehta Committee recommended democratic decentralisation, which came to be known as Panchayati Raj.
- The Balwant Rai Mehta Committee recommended a three-tier Panchayati Raj system.
- Nagaur, Rajasthan, on 2 October 1959 was the first state to establish Panchayati Raj.
- Andhra Pradesh followed Rajasthan in adopting the system in 1959.
- The Ashok Mehta Committee (1977), appointed by the Janata Government, recommended a two-tier Panchayati Raj system.
- The G.V.K. Rao Committee (1985) reviewed administrative arrangements for Rural Development and Poverty Alleviation Programmes.
- The L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986), appointed by the Rajiv Gandhi Government, recommended that PRIs be constitutionally recognised, protected and preserved.
- B.R. Mehta is known as the Father of Panchayati Raj and the Architect of Panchayati Raj.

Mnemonic - Committees in order: BAGS

B = Balwant Rai Mehta Committee (1957): democratic decentralisation; A = Ashok Mehta Committee (1977): two-tier system; G = G.V.K. Rao Committee (1985): review of rural development and poverty alleviation programmes; S = L.M. Singhvi Committee (1986): constitutional recognition of PRIs

Mind-map outline

Panchayati Raj committees

- Balwant Rai Mehta (1957)
  - Democratic decentralisation
  - Three-tier system
- Ashok Mehta (1977)
  - Appointed by Janata Government
  - Two-tier system
- G.V.K. Rao (1985)
  - Review of rural development programmes
- L.M. Singhvi (1986)
  - Constitutional recognition of PRIs
- First state
  - Nagaur, Rajasthan, 2 October 1959

### **73rd Constitutional Amendment: background and structure**

The 73rd Constitutional Amendment bill was introduced in Lok Sabha in September 1991 by the Congress government under P V Narasimha Rao. It came into force on 24 April 1993 and added Part IX, The Panchayats, to the Constitution. The amendment also added an 11th Schedule and set a three-tier structure for panchayats in every State.

- The bill was introduced in Lok Sabha in September 1991 by the Congress government under P V Narasimha Rao.
- The bill became the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992.
- The Act came into force on 24 April 1993.
- Madhya Pradesh was the first state to implement the 73rd CAA.
- A new Part IX, titled The Panchayats, covers Articles 243 to 243-O.
- An 11th Schedule was added, containing 29 subjects of panchayats (Article 243-G).
- Article 243-B provides for a three-tier system: village, intermediate and district levels.
- A State with population not exceeding 20 lakh may not constitute panchayats at the intermediate level.
- The amendment aims at governance closer to people, inclusive development, localised planning, digital transformation and transparency.

Mind-map outline

73rd CAA, 1992

- Background
  - Bill in Lok Sabha, September 1991
  - Narasimha Rao government
- Structure
  - Part IX, Articles 243 to 243-O
  - 11th Schedule: 29 subjects
  - Three-tier system (243-B)
- Commencement
  - In force 24 April 1993
  - Madhya Pradesh first state

### **Elections, reservation, term and oversight**

All members of panchayats at each level are elected directly, while chairpersons at the intermediate and district levels are chosen indirectly. The amendment provides for reservation of seats for SCs, STs and women, and sets a five-year term with time limits for fresh elections. A State Election Commission supervises electoral rolls and elections, and a Finance Commission reviews panchayat finances.

- Article 243-C: all members of panchayats at village, intermediate and district levels are elected directly.
- Chairpersons at intermediate and district levels are elected indirectly, by and from amongst the elected members.
- The village-level chairperson is elected in the manner the State Legislature determines.
- Article 243-D: seats are reserved for SCs and STs in proportion to their population.
- Not less than one-third of total seats, and of chairperson offices, are reserved for women.
- Reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes is not applicable to Arunachal Pradesh.
- Article 243-E: a panchayat has a five-year term but can be dissolved earlier.
- Fresh elections must be completed before expiry of five years, or within six months of dissolution.
- Article 243-K: a State Election Commission supervises electoral rolls and the conduct of panchayat elections; its State Election Commissioner is appointed by the Governor.
- Article 243-I: the Governor constitutes a Finance Commission every five years to review panchayat finances.

Mnemonic - Term and re-election timing: Five before, six after

Five = Five-year term; fresh elections must be completed before it expires; Six = Within six months of dissolution, if a panchayat is dissolved earlier

Mind-map outline

Elections, reservation and oversight

- Election of members

- Village, intermediate, district: direct
- Chairpersons
  - Intermediate and district: indirect
- Reservation
  - SCs and STs in proportion to population
  - Women: not less than one-third
- Term
  - Five years
  - Six months after dissolution
- Oversight
  - State Election Commission (243-K)
  - Finance Commission every five years (243-I)

## Exemptions, Union Territories and PESA

Some states and areas are exempted from Part IX, including Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram. Article 243-L lets the President extend Part IX to Union Territories with exceptions, and it applies there except Delhi. The PESA Act, 1996, enacted under Article 243-M, does not apply to Sixth Schedule areas.

- Under Article 243-M, Nagaland, Meghalaya and Mizoram are exempted.
- Scheduled Areas and Tribal Areas in the 5th and 6th Schedule states are exempted.
- Hill Areas of Manipur for which District Councils exist are exempted.
- The Darjeeling district of West Bengal, where the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exists, is exempted.
- Article 243-L: the President may direct that Part IX applies to a Union Territory, with exceptions and modifications.
- Part IX applies to all Union Territories except Delhi.
- The Provisions of the Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996, known as the PESA Act, was enacted under Article 243-M.
- The PESA Act, 1996 is not applicable to Sixth Schedule areas.
- The 6th Schedule states are Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.

Mind-map outline

Exemptions and special areas

- Exempted under 243-M
  - Nagaland, Meghalaya, Mizoram
  - Hill areas of Manipur
  - Darjeeling district, West Bengal
- Union Territories (243-L)
  - Applies to all UTs except Delhi
- PESA Act, 1996
  - Not applicable to Sixth Schedule areas
  - Sixth Schedule: Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram

## Economics

### RBI Holds Repo Rate at 5.25%

#### Repo Rate and the Economy

The Repo Rate is the rate at which the RBI lends money to commercial banks, so changes to it ripple through borrowing and spending. A lower repo rate makes loans cheaper and supports growth, while a higher repo rate curbs excess spending and eases inflation. The RBI cut the rate by 25 basis points to 5.25% in December 2025.

- Repo stands for Repurchasing Option or Repurchase Agreement
- Repo Rate: rate at which RBI lends money to commercial banks
- Lower repo rate means cheaper loans for banks and lower interest rates for borrowers
- Lower repo rate leads to increased borrowing and spending
- Higher repo rate means costlier loans for banks and higher interest rates for consumers and businesses
- RBI raises the Repo Rate during high levels of inflation to bring down the flow of money

- Higher repo rate curbs excessive spending and slows investment and money supply
- RBI lowers the Repo Rate when it needs to pump funds into the economy
- Dec 2025: RBI cut Repo Rate by 25 basis points to 5.25%
- Dec 2025 cut was the 4th reduction by RBI, totalling 125 basis points in 2025

Mind-map outline

Repo Rate effects

- Lower repo rate
  - Cheaper loans for banks
  - Borrowing and spending rise
  - Boosts growth rate
- Higher repo rate
  - Costlier loans for banks
  - Higher rates for consumers
  - Curbs excess spending
- Liquidity needs
  - RBI pumps funds: lowers repo
  - High inflation: raises repo

### Monetary Policy Committee (MPC)

The Monetary Policy Committee is a statutory body under the RBI Act, 1934 that sets the benchmark Repo Rate needed to keep inflation within the target. The Central Government constitutes it with six members, chaired ex-officio by the RBI Governor. It meets at least four times a year, decides by majority vote, and its decisions are binding on banks.

- Statutory body under the RBI Act, 1934
- Responsible for setting the benchmark policy rate (Repo Rate)
- Aim: contain inflation within the specified target level
- Central Government is empowered to constitute a 6-member MPC
- Ex-officio Chairperson: RBI Governor
- Members: Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy, one RBI officer nominated by Central Board, three members appointed by Central Government
- Meets at least four times each year
- Quorum: at least four members, including the RBI Governor or, in his absence, the Deputy Governor
- Decisions are based on majority vote; in case of a tie the RBI Governor has the casting vote
- MPC decisions are binding on banks

Mnemonic - Who sits on the MPC: Good Dogs Obey Three

G = Governor of RBI, ex-officio chairperson; D = Deputy Governor in charge of monetary policy; O = One RBI officer nominated by Central Board; Three = Three members appointed by Central Government

Mind-map outline

Monetary Policy Committee

- Composition (6 members)
  - RBI Governor: ex-officio chairperson
  - Deputy Governor: monetary policy
  - One RBI officer (Central Board)
  - Three members (Central Govt)
- Meetings and quorum
  - At least four meetings a year
  - Quorum: four members
- Decisions
  - Majority vote
  - Tie: RBI Governor casting vote
  - Binding on banks

## **Instruments of Monetary Policy**

The RBI uses several instruments to manage liquidity, borrowing costs and the money supply. The Repo Rate and Reverse Repo Rate set the rates at which the RBI lends to and borrows from banks. Reserve requirements, the Bank Rate, the Marginal Standing Facility and open market operations each work through different channels. To tighten monetary policy, the RBI raises SLR.

- Repo Rate: rate at which RBI lends money to commercial banks
- Reverse Repo Rate: rate at which RBI borrows money from commercial banks
- SLR: statutory minimum percentage of deposits a bank must keep as liquid cash, gold or other securities
- To tighten monetary policy, RBI will raise SLR
- Marginal Standing Facility: window for banks to borrow overnight funds at a rate higher than the Repo Rate
- Bank Rate: long-term rate (Repo is short-term) at which the central bank lends to other banks
- An increase in Bank Rate increases interest rates on loans and deposits
- CRR: banks must hold a proportion of their deposits as cash with the RBI
- With an increase in CRR, banks increase their lending rates
- Open Market Operations: purchase or sale of government securities to inject or absorb durable liquidity

Mind-map outline

Monetary policy instruments

- Rate-based tools
  - Repo: RBI lends to banks
  - Reverse repo: RBI borrows from banks
  - Bank Rate: long-term lending rate
  - MSF: overnight window above repo
- Reserve tools
  - SLR: liquid assets requirement
  - CRR: cash held with RBI
  - Raise SLR to tighten policy
- Open market operations
  - Buy or sell government securities
  - Inject or absorb durable liquidity

## **Inflation Targeting and the RBI**

Inflation targeting means the central bank aims to keep inflation within a pre-defined range. India adopted flexible inflation targeting in 2016 with a 4% target and a deviation of plus or minus 2%. The RBI works to maintain price stability while promoting economic growth, and performs several roles in the financial system.

- Inflation targeting: monetary policy framework where the central bank aims to keep inflation within a targeted range
- India adopted Flexible Inflation Targeting in 2016
- India's inflation target is 4%, with a deviation of +/- 2%
- Urjit Patel Committee (2014) formalised inflation targeting with a 4% target and 2% band
- The 4% target and 2% band were first proposed by the Chakravarty Committee (1982-85)
- Inflation target is set by the Government in consultation with RBI every 5 years, under the amended RBI Act, 1934
- RBI aims to maintain price stability while promoting economic growth
- RBI roles include monetary authority, lender of last resort, banker to government and custodian of forex reserves
- Retail inflation is within the mandated target band of 2-6%
- RBI was established on April 1 in Calcutta

Mind-map outline

Inflation targeting and RBI

- Inflation targeting
  - Keep inflation in a set range
  - India: flexible targeting from 2016

- Target 4%, +/-2% deviation
- History
  - Chakravarty Committee (1982-85)
  - Urjit Patel Committee (2014)
- RBI roles
  - Monetary authority
  - Lender of last resort
  - Banker to government
  - Custodian of forex reserves

## Summits, Reports and Indices

### WTO Ministerial Conference 14 (MC14)

#### MC14 Deadlock and WTO Basics

The 14th WTO Ministerial Conference, held in Yaoundé (Cameroon), ended without consensus, reflecting a deep North-South divide. Pending issues were deferred to the WTO General Council meeting in Geneva. The WTO was established on 1 January 1995, and its Ministerial Conference is its highest decision-making body.

- MC14 was held in Yaoundé, Cameroon.
- MC14 ended without consensus over the e-Commerce moratorium, agriculture and transparency norms.
- The deadlock reflects a deep North-South divide.
- Pending issues were deferred to the WTO General Council meeting in Geneva.
- The WTO was established on 1 January 1995 under the 1994 Marrakesh Agreement.
- The WTO is the successor to the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade of 1948.
- The Ministerial Conference is the WTO's highest decision-making body.
- The Ministerial Conference meets at least once every two years.
- The 13th Ministerial Conference was held in Abu Dhabi in 2024.

Mind-map outline

WTO Ministerial Conference 14

- Venue and outcome
  - Yaoundé, Cameroon
  - Ended without consensus
  - Deferred to General Council, Geneva
- WTO basics
  - Established 1 January 1995
  - Successor to GATT of 1948
  - Only organisation with global trade rules
- Ministerial Conference
  - Highest decision-making body
  - Meets at least every two years
  - 13th held in Abu Dhabi, 2024

#### E-Commerce Moratorium and Digital Trade

The WTO moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions, in place since 1998, expired at MC14 for lack of consensus. Members are therefore theoretically free to impose taxes on digital goods and services. Meanwhile, a coalition of 66 members advanced talks on a plurilateral e-commerce agreement focused on data flows, digital transactions and consumer protection.

- The moratorium on customs duties on electronic transmissions has been in place since 1998.
- The moratorium expired at MC14 due to lack of consensus.
- Members cannot impose tariffs on electronic transmissions under the 1998 arrangement.
- With the lapse, members are theoretically free to tax digital goods and services.
- The moratorium covers software, music, films and digital services.
- A coalition of 66 WTO members advanced negotiations on a plurilateral e-commerce agreement.

- Focus areas of the plurilateral e-commerce agreement are data flows, digital transactions and consumer protection.
- MC14 agenda included a decision on continuation of the moratorium on customs duties.

Mind-map outline

E-commerce moratorium

- Moratorium
  - Customs duties on electronic transmissions
  - In place since 1998
  - Lapsed at MC14 without consensus
- Coverage
  - Software
  - Music
  - Films
  - Digital services
- Plurilateral e-commerce talks
  - Coalition of 66 members
  - Data flows
  - Digital transactions
  - Consumer protection

## **Agriculture, Fisheries and Dispute Settlement**

Several MC14 agendas remained contested. Dispute settlement reform seeks to restore a two-tier binding system, because the Appellate Body has been non-functional since 2019. Agriculture talks seek a permanent solution on public stockholding for food security, while fisheries talks target bans on harmful subsidies.

- Dispute settlement reform aims to restore a two-tier binding dispute system.
- The Appellate Body has been non-functional since 2019.
- Agriculture talks seek a permanent solution for public stockholding for food security.
- The agriculture agenda also seeks to reduce trade-distorting subsidies and improve market access.
- Market access is crucial for developing countries like India.
- Developed countries remain reluctant to expand PSH flexibilities.
- Fisheries talks aim to ban harmful subsidies causing overcapacity and overfishing.
- Members agreed to continue negotiations on curbing subsidies for distant-water fishing fleets.
- LDC graduation support includes transition mechanisms for trade benefits.
- The future roadmap aims to finalise outcomes by MC15.

Mind-map outline

Key agendas at MC14

- Dispute settlement
  - Restore two-tier binding system
  - Appellate Body non-functional since 2019
- Agriculture
  - Permanent solution for public stockholding
  - Reduce trade-distorting subsidies
  - Improve market access
- Fisheries
  - Ban harmful subsidies
  - Overcapacity and overfishing
  - Distant-water fleet subsidies
- LDC graduation
  - Support countries losing LDC status
  - Transition mechanisms for trade benefits

## Investment Facilitation for Development (IFD)

The IFD Agreement is a plurilateral pact, binding only on its signatories, that aims to make investment procedures transparent, efficient and predictable. It was launched under a Joint Statement Initiative at MC11 in Buenos Aires in 2017 and finalised in 2023. India opposed bringing it into the WTO's multilateral framework, citing mandate, consensus, policy space and geopolitical concerns.

- The IFD Agreement is a plurilateral agreement, binding only on signatories.
- It was launched under a Joint Statement Initiative at MC11, Buenos Aires, in 2017.
- It was finalised in 2023.
- The IFD Agreement is based on the Most-Favoured-Nation principle.
- Its objective is to make investment procedures transparent, efficient and predictable.
- It covers investment facilitation: procedures, approvals and transparency.
- It excludes market access, investment protection, government procurement and investor-state dispute settlement.
- Its firewall clause prevents IFD rules from overriding Bilateral Investment Treaties.
- Its appeal mechanism requires independent tribunals for dispute review.
- India's concerns: investment is not strictly a trade subject, JSIs seem to bypass consensus, binding rules may limit FDI regulation, and geopolitical concerns.

Mnemonic - India's concerns on IFD: MCPG: My Cat Plays Games

M = Mandate: investment is not strictly a trade subject; C = Consensus: JSIs seen as bypassing the consensus rule; P = Policy space: binding rules may limit India's FDI regulation; G = Geopolitics: majority supporters linked to Belt and Road Initiative

Mind-map outline

Investment Facilitation for Development

- Nature
  - Plurilateral, binding on signatories
  - Launched at MC11, Buenos Aires, 2017
  - Finalised in 2023
- Coverage
  - Investment procedures and approvals
  - Excludes market access
  - Excludes investor-state dispute settlement
- Safeguards
  - Firewall clause for BITs
  - Independent appeal tribunals
- India's concerns
  - WTO mandate issue
  - Consensus principle
  - Policy space
  - Geopolitical concerns

## Environment and Disaster Management

### World Air Quality Report 2025

#### IQAir report 2025: scope and compliance

The 8th World Air Quality Report 2025 was released by Swiss IQAir, which assesses air quality using PM2.5 concentrations. IQAir's coverage grew from 134 countries in 2023 to 143 countries and 9,446 cities in 2025. Only 14% of cities met the WHO PM2.5 annual guideline in 2025, down from 17% in 2024.

- Report: 8th World Air Quality Report 2025, by Swiss IQAir
- IQAir assessments are based on PM2.5 (fine particulate matter) concentrations
- Coverage: 134 countries in 2023, then 143 countries and 9,446 cities in 2025
- Only 14% of cities complied with the WHO PM2.5 annual guideline in 2025
- City compliance share declined from 17% in 2024
- Only 13 countries/territories met the WHO PM2.5 guidelines

- 130 of 143 countries and territories failed to meet safe air quality standards
- Nieuwoudtville (South Africa) recorded as World's Cleanest City, PM2.5 level 1.0 µg/m<sup>3</sup>
- IQAir is a Swiss air quality technology company founded in 1963, HQ in Goldach, Switzerland

Mind-map outline

IQAir report 2025

- Measure: PM2.5 concentrations
  - Fine particulate matter
- Coverage: 143 countries, 9,446 cities
  - Up from 134 countries in 2023
- WHO compliance
  - Cities: 14% in 2025, 17% in 2024
  - Countries: 13 met guideline
  - 130 of 143 failed standards
- Cleanest city: Nieuwoudtville
  - PM2.5 level 1.0 µg/m<sup>3</sup>

### **Most polluted countries, cities and regions**

Pakistan was the most polluted country in 2025, with PM2.5 levels over 13 times the WHO limit. Loni in Uttar Pradesh was the most polluted city, about 22 times above WHO guidelines. Five of the world's ten most polluted cities are in India, and Central and South Asia remain the most polluted regions globally.

- Most polluted country in 2025: Pakistan, PM2.5 at 67.3 µg/m<sup>3</sup>
- Pakistan's PM2.5 level is over 13 times the WHO limit
- Pakistan was followed by Bangladesh, Tajikistan, Chad and Democratic Republic of Congo
- Most polluted city: Loni, Uttar Pradesh, about 22 times WHO guidelines
- 5 of the world's 10 most polluted cities are in India: Loni, Byrnihat, Delhi, Ghaziabad, Ula
- India ranked 6th most polluted country in 2025 (5th in 2024)
- New Delhi is the world's most polluted capital for 8 consecutive years
- India accounted for 74 of the world's 100 most polluted cities in 2024
- Central and South Asia remain the most polluted regions globally

Mind-map outline

Most polluted places 2025

- Country: Pakistan
  - PM2.5 67.3 µg/m<sup>3</sup>
  - Over 13 times WHO limit
- City: Loni, Uttar Pradesh
  - About 22 times WHO guideline
- India: 5 of top 10 cities
  - Loni, Byrnihat, Delhi, Ghaziabad, Ula
- India: 6th most polluted country
- Regions: Central and South Asia

### **National framework and monitoring tools in India**

India's National Air Quality Index, launched in 2014, explains pollution in simple categories. The Graded Response Action Plan is an emergency measure that applies only when air quality shifts from Poor to Very Poor, and the Supreme Court approved it in 2016. The National Clean Air Programme, launched in 2019, targets a 40% cut in average particulate matter by 2026 in 131 cities.

- National Air Quality Index (2014) communicates air quality in easy terms; launched by Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)
- AQI categories: Good, Satisfactory, Moderate, Poor, Very Poor, Severe
- GRAP (2017): emergency measures that kick in only when air quality shifts from Poor to Very Poor
- GRAP was submitted by CPCB and approved by the Supreme Court in 2016 (MC Mehta vs Union of India)
- GRAP is implemented by the Commission for Air Quality Management
- National Clean Air Programme launched in 2019 by the Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change

- NCAP goal: 40% reduction in average particulate matter concentrations by 2026 in 131 cities
- The 131 non-attainment cities under NCAP were identified by CPCB
- PRANA portal launched to track NCAP progress and regulate air pollution in non-attainment cities
- SAFAR is a Ministry of Earth Sciences initiative for city-wide and localised air quality monitoring

Mnemonic - AQI categories in order: Good Students Make Pretty Very Smart

Good = Good category; Students = Satisfactory category; Make = Moderate category; Pretty = Poor category; Very = Very Poor category; Smart = Severe category

Mnemonic - NCAP target: Forty fans cheer 2026 at 131 cities

Forty = 40% cut in average particulate matter; 2026 = target year; 131 = non-attainment cities covered

Mind-map outline

National framework in India

- Public information: AQI (2014)
  - Six categories, Good to Severe
- Emergency action: GRAP (2017)
  - Acts when Poor shifts to Very Poor
  - Supreme Court approval in 2016
- Long-term target: NCAP (2019)
  - 40% cut by 2026
  - 131 non-attainment cities
- Tracking: PRANA portal
- Monitoring: SAFAR (Ministry of Earth Sciences)

## Vehicle, fuel, farm and legal measures

Vehicle norms, clean-fuel schemes and farm tools target different sources of pollution. Bharat Stage VI became mandatory nationwide in 2020, while FAME promotes electric and hybrid vehicles. Legal protection includes the Fundamental Duty in Article 51A(g), added in 1976, and the reading of Article 21 to cover a healthy environment.

- Bharat Stage VI (2020): mandatory leap from BS-IV to BS-VI, implemented nationwide
- FAME scheme promotes adoption of electric and hybrid vehicles
- Pradhan Mantri Ujjwala Yojana provides LPG as clean cooking fuel, reducing biomass-based cooking
- SATAT initiative promotes compressed bio-gas to manage agricultural waste
- GRIHA encourages sustainable, eco-friendly practices in building construction and operation
- Turbo Happy Seeder uproots stubble and sows seeds in the cleared area
- Pusa Bio-Decomposer turns crop residue into manure in 15-20 days; developed by Indian Agricultural Research Institute
- 42nd Amendment (1976) inserted Clause (g) in Article 51A: protecting and improving the natural environment is a Fundamental Duty
- Article 21 interpreted to include the right to a healthy environment
- Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981; Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974; Environment Protection Act, 1986

Mind-map outline

Vehicle, fuel, farm and legal measures

- Vehicles
  - BS-VI mandatory from 2020
  - FAME: electric and hybrid vehicles
- Clean fuel
  - Ujjwala: LPG cooking fuel
  - SATAT: compressed bio-gas
- Farm stubble
  - Turbo Happy Seeder
  - Pusa Bio-Decomposer: residue to manure
- Buildings: GRIHA
- Legal basis
  - Article 51A(g) Fundamental Duty
  - Article 21: healthy environment

## Science and Technology, Defence and Space

## PFBR at Kalpakkam Achieves Criticality

### Criticality and neutron balance

A reactor reaches criticality when its nuclear fission chain reaction becomes self-sustaining, and this depends on the balance of the neutron population in the core. The multiplication factor  $k$  compares the neutrons in one generation with the previous generation. The value of  $k$  decides whether a reactor is subcritical, critical or supercritical.

- Criticality: the state in which the nuclear fission chain reaction is self-sustaining.
- Depends on the neutron population balance in the reactor core.
- Multiplication factor  $k$ : neutrons in one generation divided by neutrons in the previous generation.
- Subcritical ( $k < 1$ ): neutron population decreases and the chain reaction dies out.
- Critical ( $k = 1$ ): neutron population remains constant and the reaction is steady and self-sustaining.
- Supercritical ( $k > 1$ ): neutron population increases exponentially and power output rises rapidly.
- The PFBR achieved its first criticality, marking entry into Stage II of the nuclear programme.

Mnemonic - Subcritical, critical, supercritical: Die, Hold, Climb

Die = Subcritical state ( $k$  less than 1): the chain reaction dies out.; Hold = Critical state ( $k$  equals 1): the neutron population remains constant.; Climb = Supercritical state ( $k$  greater than 1): power output rises rapidly.

Mind-map outline

Reactor criticality

- Self-sustaining fission chain reaction
  - Depends on neutron population balance
- Multiplication factor  $k$ 
  - Neutrons per generation / previous generation
- Three states
  - Subcritical:  $k$  below 1, chain dies out
  - Critical:  $k$  equals 1, steady
  - Supercritical:  $k$  above 1, power rises

### PFBR design and breeding

The Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor uses Mixed Oxide fuel derived from reprocessed spent fuel. Its core is surrounded by a Uranium-238 blanket in which fast neutrons convert U-238 into Plutonium-239. Liquid sodium is the coolant, and the reactor has a capacity of 500 MWe.

- Fuel: Mixed Oxide (MOX) of plutonium and uranium.
- The MOX fuel is derived from reprocessed spent fuel.
- The core is surrounded by a Uranium-238 blanket, called the breeder blanket.
- The breeder mechanism converts U-238 into Plutonium-239.
- Uses fast neutrons to produce more nuclear fuel than it consumes while generating power.
- Coolant system uses liquid sodium.
- Liquid sodium has high thermal conductivity and does not slow neutrons.
- Type: Fast Breeder Reactor with a capacity of 500 MWe.

Mind-map outline

PFBR design

- Fuel: MOX from reprocessed spent fuel
- Breeder blanket around core
  - U-238 converts to Pu-239
  - Fast neutrons produce fuel
- Coolant: liquid sodium
  - High thermal conductivity
  - Does not slow neutrons
- Capacity: 500 MWe

## Benefits: fuel, waste and energy

The PFBR produces more fuel than it consumes, which extends the use of nuclear resources. It recycles spent fuel from Stage I reactors, which reduces the volume of nuclear waste and its long-term radiotoxicity. The booklet also says it extracts about 60 times more energy from natural uranium than traditional PHWRs.

- Result: the PFBR produces more fuel than it consumes.
- Waste reduction: recycles spent fuel from Stage I reactors.
- Reduces the volume of nuclear waste.
- Reduces long-term radiotoxicity of nuclear waste.
- Energy efficiency: extracts about 60 times more energy from natural uranium than traditional PHWRs.
- PHWR stands for Pressurized Heavy Water Reactor, the comparison point for energy efficiency.

Mind-map outline

Benefits of the PFBR

- Fuel: produces more than it consumes
- Waste: recycles Stage I spent fuel
  - Reduces waste volume
  - Reduces long-term radiotoxicity
- Energy: more than PHWRs
  - About 60 times more from natural uranium

## India's three-stage nuclear programme

India's three-stage nuclear power programme was formulated by Homi Jehangir Bhabha to achieve long-term energy security using uranium and thorium resources. Stage I uses PHWRs, Stage II uses fast breeder reactors with MOX fuel and liquid sodium, and Stage III uses thorium-based advanced reactors. India presently has 24 nuclear power reactors operating in 6 states.

- Formulated by Homi Jehangir Bhabha.
- Aim: long-term energy security using uranium and thorium resources.
- Stage I: PHWR with natural uranium fuel, heavy water coolant and heavy water moderator.
- Stage I breeds Plutonium-239.
- Stage II: Fast Breeder Reactor using MOX (Pu-239 + U-238) fuel and liquid sodium coolant.
- Stage III: Advanced HWR / Thermal Breeder using Uranium-233 derived from thorium.
- Stage III uses light water as coolant and heavy water as moderator.
- India presently has 24 nuclear power reactors operating in 6 states, with installed capacity of 8780 MWe.
- Kudankulam Power Plant in Tamil Nadu is the newest and largest; Tarapur Power Plant in Maharashtra is the first and oldest.
- Atomic Energy Act, 1962 governs nuclear facilities; the Atomic Energy Regulatory Board (AERB) regulates them.

Mnemonic - Fuel across the three stages: Natural, Mixed, Thorium

Natural = Stage I PHWRs use natural uranium fuel.; Mixed = Stage II fast breeder reactors use MOX fuel of plutonium and uranium.; Thorium = Stage III uses Uranium-233 derived from thorium.

Mind-map outline

Three-stage nuclear programme

- Stage I: PHWR
  - Natural uranium fuel
  - Heavy water coolant and moderator
- Stage II: Fast breeder reactor
  - MOX fuel
  - Liquid sodium coolant
- Stage III: Advanced HWR / thermal breeder
  - Uranium-233 from thorium fuel
  - Light water coolant
- Status today
  - 24 reactors in 6 states
  - Kudankulam: newest and largest
  - Tarapur: first and oldest

## INS Aridaman: India's Third Nuclear-Powered Ballistic Missile Submarine

### INS Aridaman and SSBN Features

India commissioned INS Aridaman, its third nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine, which marks a milestone of 3 operational SSBNs at sea. It is an indigenous Arihant-class SSBN powered by an 83 MW Pressurised Compact Light-Water Reactor. The booklet describes it as equipped with 8 vertical launch systems and as carrying K-4 missiles with a 3,500 km range. SSBNs are typically the largest and most complex type of nuclear-powered submarine.

- INS Aridaman is India's 3rd nuclear-powered ballistic missile submarine (SSBN).
- Its commissioning marks a milestone of 3 operational SSBNs at sea.
- It is the 3rd indigenous Arihant-class SSBN, after INS Arihant and INS Arighaat.
- Powered by an 83 MW Pressurised Compact Light-Water Reactor.
- Equipped with 8 vertical launch systems.
- Firepower: K-4 missiles with 3,500 km range, plus capability to carry more K-15 missiles.
- Built at the Ship Building Centre, Visakhapatnam, under the ATV programme.
- Benefits: stealth (low noise), extended submerged operations and improved survivability.
- SSBN stands for Ship Submersible Ballistic Nuclear; it can carry ballistic missiles that may be nuclear armed.

Mnemonic - SSBN Expansion: Sea Sentries Boast Nukes

Sea = S = Ship; Sentries = S = Submersible; Boast = B = Ballistic; Nukes = N = Nuclear

Mind-map outline

INS Aridaman features

- Class: 3rd Arihant-class SSBN
- Reactor: 83 MW light-water
- Weapons
  - K-4 missiles, 3,500 km range
  - More K-15 missiles possible
- 8 vertical launch systems
- Built at Visakhapatnam under ATV
- Benefits: stealth, endurance, survivability

### Arihant-Class Submarines

The booklet shows the Arihant class with three submarines: INS Arihant (commissioned 2016), INS Arighaat (commissioned 2024) and INS Aridaman. INS Arighaat is similar to Arihant in power, launch tubes and displacement but much more technologically advanced. The specifications of Arihant-class submarines are classified, so the booklet's sketch is only an approximation. Nuclear submarines are grouped into SSN, SSGN and SSBN types, each with a different weapons role.

- The Arihant-class comparison covers three submarines: INS Arihant, INS Arighaat and INS Aridaman.
- INS Arihant was commissioned in 2016; its firepower is K-15 Sagarika missiles.
- INS Arighaat was commissioned in 2024.
- INS Arighaat is similar to Arihant in power, launch tubes and displacement, but much more technologically advanced.
- Specifications of Arihant-class submarines are classified; the sketch is an approximation.
- SSN (Submersible Ship Nuclear) carries conventional weapons.
- SSGN (Ship Submersible Guided Nuclear) carries guided missiles with conventional warheads.
- SSBN is typically the largest and most complex type of nuclear-powered submarine.

Mind-map outline

Arihant-class submarines

- INS Arihant: commissioned 2016
  - Firepower: K-15 Sagarika
- INS Arighaat: commissioned 2024
  - Similar power, tubes, displacement
  - More technologically advanced
- INS Aridaman: 3rd class member
  - Carries K-4 missiles
- Submarine types

- SSN: conventional weapons
- SSGN: guided missiles, conventional warheads
- SSBN: ballistic, may be nuclear armed

### **Strategic Significance for India**

INS Aridaman completes India's nuclear triad, which enables nuclear delivery from land, air and sea. Its second-strike capability provides assured retaliation and supports the No First Use doctrine. The booklet says the submarine improves strategic reach in the Indian Ocean Region and Indo-Pacific and boosts Credible Minimum Deterrence. India is placed among the countries with operational nuclear triads, which the booklet lists as USA, Russia, UK, China and France.

- Completes India's nuclear triad, enabling nuclear delivery via land, air and sea.
- Provides second-strike capability, meaning assured retaliation capability.
- Supports India's No First Use doctrine.
- Improves strategic reach in the Indian Ocean Region and Indo-Pacific.
- Boosts Credible Minimum Deterrence.
- Places India among countries with operational nuclear triads.
- Other countries with operational nuclear triads listed: USA, Russia, UK, China, France.

Mind-map outline

Strategic significance of INS Aridaman

- Nuclear triad
  - Delivery via land, air and sea
- Second strike
  - Assured retaliation
  - Supports No First Use doctrine
- Deterrence
  - Credible Minimum Deterrence
  - Reach in IOR and Indo-Pacific
- Global status
  - Operational triads: USA, Russia, UK, China, France

### **Submarine Building Programmes**

The 30-year Submarine Building Plan was approved by the Cabinet Committee on Security in 1999, after the Kargil War, and aimed to build 24 conventional submarines indigenously by 2030. Under Project 75, six Kalvari-class diesel-electric submarines were being built at Mazagon Dock Limited, and INS Kalvari was commissioned in 2017. Project 75I, approved in 2007 as Phase II, is the first project under the Strategic Partnership Model. Project 75I adds AIP technology, which lets submarines stay submerged for up to 2 weeks.

- After the Kargil War (1999), the Cabinet Committee on Security approved a 30-year Submarine Building Plan.
- The plan included building 24 conventional submarines indigenously by 2030.
- Project 75 is Phase I (2000-2015) of the Indian Navy's 30-year indigenous submarine plan.
- Six Kalvari-class (Scorpene-based) diesel-electric attack submarines were being built at Mazagon Dock Limited.
- INS Kalvari, the first Project 75 submarine, was commissioned in 2017.
- Project 75I, approved in 2007 as Phase II, is the first project under the Strategic Partnership Model.
- Project 75I aims to procure diesel-electric attack submarines with fuel cells and AIP.
- Conventional diesel-electric submarines must surface every 48 hours to be recharged.
- Project 75I uses AIP technology to build six submarines that can stay submerged for up to 2 weeks.
- Five foreign OEMs: Daewoo (South Korea), Naval Group (France), Rosoboronexport (Russia), Thyssenkrupp Marine Systems (TKMS, Germany), Navantia (Spain).

Mind-map outline

Submarine building programmes

- 30-year plan (1999)
  - 24 conventional submarines by 2030
- Project 75 (Phase I)

- Six Kalvari-class submarines
- INS Kalvari commissioned 2017
- Project 75I (Phase II)
  - Approved 2007
  - Strategic Partnership Model
- Project 751
  - AIP technology
  - Submerged up to 2 weeks

## **NASA's Artemis Programme and Space Missions**

### **Artemis Programme and the Artemis II Mission**

NASA's Artemis Programme aims to land humans on the Moon and is named after the Moon Goddess of Greek mythology. It proceeds in stages, beginning with an unmanned Artemis I that launched the Orion spacecraft, followed by the crewed Artemis II lunar flyby and then Artemis III, which is to return humans to the Moon. A Lunar Gateway Station is planned as a docking point for astronauts and for scientific research.

- Artemis is named after the Moon Goddess in Greek mythology.
- Objective: land humans on the Moon by 2025, including the first woman and the first person of colour.
- Artemis I was an unmanned mission that began with the launch of the Orion spacecraft on the Space Launch System.
- Artemis II is a crewed lunar flyby; astronauts travel around the Moon and return to Earth without landing.
- Artemis II crew of four: Reid Wiseman (Commander), Victor Glover, Christina Koch and Jeremy Hansen.
- Jeremy Hansen is the first Canadian and non-American to fly on a lunar mission.
- Artemis II is expected to last about 10 days, following a free-return trajectory, and splash down in the Pacific Ocean.
- Artemis II launch site: Kennedy Space Center, Florida, USA.
- Artemis III aims to return humans to the Moon.
- Lunar Gateway Station is planned for 2029, serving as a docking point and for scientific research.

Mind-map outline

Artemis Programme

- Artemis I: unmanned Orion launch
- Artemis II: crewed lunar flyby
  - Crew of four astronauts
  - Splashdown in Pacific Ocean
- Artemis III: humans return to Moon
- Lunar Gateway Station planned for 2029

### **Artemis Accords**

The Artemis Accords were announced by NASA in 2020 and were established by the US State Department and NASA together with seven other founding members. They set out common principles for the civil exploration and use of outer space, including the Moon, Mars, comets and asteroids, for peaceful purposes. The Accords build on the Outer Space Treaty of 1967 but are not legally binding.

- Announced by NASA in 2020.
- Established by the US State Department and NASA with 7 other founding members.
- Founding members include Australia, Canada, Italy, Japan, Luxembourg, the United Arab Emirates and the United Kingdom.
- A set of principles and guidelines for international cooperation in space exploration.
- Purpose: common principles to govern civil exploration and use of outer space, the Moon, Mars, comets and asteroids, for peaceful purposes.
- Builds upon the Outer Space Treaty of 1967.
- Nature: not legally binding.
- Members: 63 countries.

- India joined in 2023 as the 27th member.
- Russia and China are not part of the Artemis Accords.

#### Mind-map outline

##### Artemis Accords

- Origin: announced 2020
- Purpose: peaceful exploration
- Basis: Outer Space Treaty 1967
- Status: not legally binding
- Members: 63 countries

## Human Spaceflight and Gaganyaan

Yuri Gagarin of the Soviet Union was the first human in space in 1961, and Valentina Tereshkova was the first woman in space in 1963. India's Gaganyaan Project will launch a three-person crew on a three-day mission to a 400 km orbit, which would make India the fourth nation to do so after the United States, Russia and China. Vyommitra and the SAKHI app support the programme, with Vyommitra flying ahead of Gaganyaan and SAKHI supporting crew health and communication.

- Yuri Gagarin, Soviet cosmonaut, was the first human in space (Vostok, 12 April 1961).
- Valentina Tereshkova was the first woman to enter space (1963).
- Rakesh Sharma was the first Indian in space (Soyuz T-11, 3 April 1984).
- Shubhanshu Shukla was the second Indian in space and the first on the ISS (Axiom-4, 2025).
- Gaganyaan is India's first human spaceflight programme, with a three-person crew on a three-day mission to a 400 km orbit.
- Gaganyaan would make India the 4th nation to launch humans after the United States, Russia and China.
- Out of 4 astronaut designates (Vyomnauts), 3 will be selected for the final mission.
- Gaganyaan comprises a crew module and a service module; developed by ISRO and launched on GSLV Mk III (LVM3).
- Crew training takes place at the Human Space Flight Centre, Bengaluru.
- Vyommitra is a woman robot astronaut (half humanoid) that will fly ahead of Gaganyaan; the name means Space-Friend.

Mnemonic - Gaganyaan key numbers: Three Friends, Three Days, Four Hundred

Three (first) = Crew members on the Gaganyaan mission; Three (second) = Days in the Gaganyaan mission; Four Hundred = Kilometres of the 400 km orbit

#### Mind-map outline

##### Human Spaceflight

- Early milestones
  - Gagarin: 1961
  - Tereshkova: 1963
- Gaganyaan
  - 3-person crew, 3-day mission
  - 400 km orbit
  - 3 of 4 designates selected
- Support systems
  - Vyommitra robot
  - SAKHI app

## Lunar Missions: Chandrayaan and Moon Landings

India's Chandrayaan-1, launched in 2008, mapped the Moon's surface in unprecedented detail and found water ice in polar craters. Chandrayaan-3, launched in 2023, made India the first nation to soft-land on the lunar South Pole. Chandrayaan-4 is slated for 2028 to bring rock samples back to Earth, and Chandrayaan-5 is a joint mission of ISRO and JAXA to explore the Moon for water and other resources.

- Chandrayaan-1 (2008) was India's first lunar mission.
- Chandrayaan-1 mapped the Moon's surface in unprecedented detail, discovering water ice in polar craters.
- Chandrayaan-2 (2019) carried an orbiter, the Vikram lander and the Pragyan (Wisdom) rover.

- Chandrayaan-3 (2023) was a second attempt after Chandrayaan-2, using GSLV Mk III.
- With Chandrayaan-3, India became the first nation to soft-land on the lunar South Pole.
- With Chandrayaan-3, India became the 4th nation to soft-land anywhere on the Moon.
- Chandrayaan-4 is slated for launch in 2028 and aims to bring lunar rock samples back to Earth.
- Chandrayaan-5 (Lunar Polar Exploration, LUPAX) is a joint initiative of ISRO and JAXA.
- Landing on the Moon: Soviet Union first (Luna 9, 1966), United States second (Apollo, 1969), China third (Chang'e, 2013).
- Japan became the 5th nation to land on the Moon (SLIM, 2024).

Mnemonic - Moon landing order: Silly Unicorns Chase Iguanas Jumping

S = Soviet Union: first nation to land on the Moon (Luna 9, 1966); U = United States: second nation (Apollo, 1969); C = China: third nation (Chang'e, 2013); I = India: fourth nation to soft-land anywhere on the Moon (Chandrayaan-3); J = Japan: fifth nation to land on the Moon (SLIM, 2024)

Mind-map outline

Lunar Missions

- Chandrayaan-1
  - 2008: Moon mapping
  - Water ice in polar craters
- Chandrayaan-3
  - 2023: south pole soft landing
- Chandrayaan-4 and 5
  - 2028: rock samples to Earth
  - ISRO and JAXA joint mission
- Moon landings
  - Soviet Union 1966
  - United States 1969
  - China 2013
  - Japan 2024

## Sports, Awards and Days

### R. Vaishali's FIDE Women's Candidates Win 2026

#### Vaishali's Candidates win

R. Vaishali won the FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament 2026 in Nicosia, Cyprus, by defeating Kateryna Lagno of Russia in the final round. She finished with 8.5 out of 14 points and became the first Indian woman to claim the Candidates title. Her next challenge is the Women's World Chess Championship against Ju Wenjun of China, later in 2026.

- Event: FIDE Women's Candidates Tournament 2026
- Venue: Nicosia, Cyprus
- Final round: defeated Kateryna Lagno (Russia) to clinch the title
- Final score: 8.5 out of 14 points
- Milestone: first Indian woman to claim the Candidates title
- Next challenge: reigning champion Ju Wenjun (China)
- Women's World Chess Championship challenge due later in 2026

Mind-map outline

Vaishali's Candidates win

- Venue: Nicosia, Cyprus
- Final opponent: Kateryna Lagno
- Score: 8.5 out of 14
- Milestone: first Indian woman title
- Next: Ju Wenjun challenge, later 2026

## India's world titles and milestones

Indian players hold several major chess titles. Viswanathan Anand won the FIDE World Chess Championship five times, and Gukesh Dommaraju became world champion in 2024 as the second Indian to win the title. Divya Deshmukh and Pranav Venkatesh added to India's record in 2025, and Koneru Humpy has a 2019 world rapid title.

- Viswanathan Anand won the FIDE World Chess Championship in 2000, 2007, 2008, 2010 and 2012
- Gukesh Dommaraju won the FIDE World Chess Championship 2024, held in Singapore
- Gukesh defeated Ding Liren (China) to become world champion
- Gukesh is the 2nd Indian to win the FIDE World Chess Championship, after Anand
- Gukesh is the 18th World Chess Champion in history
- Divya Deshmukh won the FIDE Women's World Cup 2025 in Batumi, Georgia
- Divya defeated Koneru Humpy in the Women's World Cup 2025 final
- Pranav Venkatesh won the FIDE World Junior Chess Championship 2025 in Montenegro
- Pranav is the 4th Indian to win the World Junior title, after Anand, Pentala Harikrishna and Abhijeet Gupta
- Koneru Humpy clinched the Women's World Rapid Chess Championship title in 2019

Mind-map outline

India's world titles and milestones

- Viswanathan Anand
  - Five FIDE world titles, 2000-2012
- Gukesh Dommaraju
  - World champion 2024, Singapore
  - Defeated Ding Liren (China)
- Divya Deshmukh
  - Women's World Cup 2025, Batumi
- Pranav Venkatesh
  - World Junior title 2025, Montenegro
- Koneru Humpy
  - Women's World Rapid title, 2019

## FIDE, the global chess body

FIDE (Fédération Internationale des Échecs), the International Chess Federation, is the global governing authority for chess. Founded in Paris in 1924, it oversees major international competitions and sets rules and rating standards. Its headquarters is in Lausanne, Switzerland, and Arkady Dvorkovich is its President.

- Full name: Fédération Internationale des Échecs (International Chess Federation)
- Established in Paris in 1924
- Headquarters: Lausanne, Switzerland
- Serves as the global governing authority for chess
- Oversees all major international competitions
- Sets rules and rating standards
- President: Arkady Dvorkovich
- Deputy President: Viswanathan Anand
- Motto: Gens una Sumus (We are One Family)
- International Chess Day on 20 July marks FIDE's foundation; 2025 theme 'Every Move Counts'

Mnemonic - FIDE at a glance: Paris Finds, Lausanne Houses

Paris = FIDE was established in Paris in 1924; Lausanne = FIDE's headquarters is in Lausanne, Switzerland

Mind-map outline

FIDE: International Chess Federation

- Founded in Paris, 1924
- Headquarters in Lausanne
- Role
  - Global governing authority
  - Oversees major competitions
  - Sets rules and rating standards

- Leadership
  - President: Arkady Dvorkovich
  - Deputy President: Viswanathan Anand

## Chess history and records

Chess has a long history, from its origin as 'Chaturanga' in Northern India during the Gupta Empire to the World Chess Championship, first contested in 1886. Recent events include India hosting the Chess World Cup 2025 in Goa and India's first-ever Olympiad gold in 2024. Several records involve very young players and wins over Magnus Carlsen.

- World Chess Championship established in 1886; Wilhelm Steinitz became the 1st official champion
- Chess originated in Northern India during the Gupta Empire (6th century CE) as 'Chaturanga'
- India hosted the Chess World Cup 2025 in Goa, its second time after Hyderabad in 2002
- Javokhir Sindarov (Uzbek) won the Chess World Cup 2025
- Indian men's and women's teams won their first-ever gold at the 45th Chess Olympiad in Budapest, Hungary, in 2024
- R. Praggnanandhaa became the youngest player to reach a World Cup final, and only the 2nd Indian after Viswanathan Anand to do so
- Gukesh Dommaraju secured his first classical win over Magnus Carlsen at Norway Chess 2025
- R. Praggnanandhaa was the first Indian to defeat Magnus Carlsen in classical chess
- Abhimanyu Mishra (USA) holds the record as the world's youngest chess Grandmaster
- Anish Sarkar, aged 3 and from Kolkata, became the youngest chess player ever ranked by FIDE

Mind-map outline

Chess history and records

- Origin
  - Chaturanga, Northern India, Gupta Empire
- World Championship since 1886
  - Steinitz: first official champion
- Recent events
  - Chess World Cup 2025 in Goa
  - Olympiad 2024 gold, Budapest
- Records
  - Youngest World Cup finalist: Praggnanandhaa
  - Youngest Grandmaster: Abhimanyu Mishra
  - Youngest ranked: Anish Sarkar

## Miscellaneous

### Miscellaneous: Current Affairs April 2026

#### Digital Platforms and Online Gaming

A US jury found Meta Platforms and YouTube liable for addictive platform design, shifting attention from content to design. India's Promotion and Regulation of Online Gaming Act, 2025 prohibits online money gaming, and the PROG Rules 2026 take effect from 1 May 2026. UPI completed 10 years in 2026 as a leading real-time payment system.

- US jury found Meta Platforms and YouTube guilty of designing addictive platforms
- Addictive features included endless scrolling and algorithm-driven feeds
- Liability split: Meta about 70 per cent, YouTube about 30 per cent
- Total compensation in the case: USD 6 million
- Court avoided Section 230 of the Communications Decency Act, 1996; platforms treated as products
- PROG Rules 2026 notified by MeitY, effective from 1 May 2026
- Online Gaming Act 2025 prohibits online money gaming and permits e-sports and social games
- Regulator: Online Gaming Authority of India (MeitY); final appeal lies to Secretary, MeitY
- UPI completed 10 years in 2026; NPCI established in 2008
- UPI operates under the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007

Mind-map outline

Digital platforms and online gaming

- Social media addiction case
  - Liability for design, not content
  - Court avoided Section 230 protection
  - Meta about 70%, YouTube about 30%
- Online gaming rules
  - Online money gaming prohibited
  - E-sports and social games permitted
  - Regulator: OGAI under MeitY
- UPI
  - Launched in 2016
  - Operated by NPCI

## International Relations

The United States and Iran agreed to a 2-week ceasefire after a prolonged conflict, with formal peace talks planned from 11 April 2026 in Islamabad. The ceasefire is conditional, and the US excluded Lebanon from it. India and South Korea elevated ties to a Futuristic Partnership under a Joint Strategic Vision during President Lee Jae-myung's visit.

- US and Iran agreed to a 2-week ceasefire after a prolonged conflict
- Formal peace talks to begin on 11 April 2026 in Islamabad, led by US VP JD Vance
- Iran agreed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz for 2 weeks
- US demands complete dismantling of Natanz, Isfahan and Fordow nuclear sites
- US excludes Lebanon from the ceasefire
- India-South Korea ties elevated to a Futuristic Partnership under a Joint Strategic Vision
- India and South Korea signed 4 MoUs during President Lee Jae-myung's visit
- Maritime cooperation: KOICA to map workforce gaps and set up a joint shipbuilding training centre
- South Korea joins International Solar Alliance and Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative
- 2028-29 declared as Year of India-ROK Friendship with focus on K-Pop, cinema and sports

Mind-map outline

International relations

- US-Iran ceasefire
  - 2-week ceasefire
  - Hormuz reopened for 2 weeks
  - Lebanon excluded
- Peace talks from 11 April
  - Venue: Islamabad
  - Led by US VP JD Vance
- India-South Korea ties
  - Futuristic Partnership
  - 4 MoUs signed
  - Year of Friendship 2028-29

## Polity, Governance and Schemes

The Supreme Court reaffirmed that Scheduled Caste status is limited to Hindus, Sikhs and Buddhists, so conversion to another religion leads to loss of SC status. Parliament passed the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill, 2026, naming Amaravati as the sole capital. Several government schemes were also extended or expanded, including the PM Internship Scheme and PMGSY-III.

- SC status limited to Hindus, Sikhs and Buddhists under the Constitution (SC) Order, 1950
- Conversion to another religion leads to loss of SC status
- Doctrine of Eclipse: SC status is suspended, not permanently extinguished
- Re-conversion to Hinduism, Sikhism or Buddhism can restore SC status
- Only Parliament can amend the SC list
- AP Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill, 2026 declares Amaravati as the sole capital
- The AP amendment has retrospective effect from 2 June 2024
- PM Internship Scheme: age 18-25 years; target of 1 crore internships over 5 years

- PMGSY-III extended till March 2028; funding 60:40 (plain states) and 90:10 (NE and Himalayan states)
- Namo Drone Didi Yojana: target of 15,000 drones for SHGs; Karnataka is top performer

Mind-map outline

Polity, governance and schemes

- SC status
  - Limited to Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists
  - Doctrine of Eclipse
  - Only Parliament amends SC list
- AP Reorganisation Amendment
  - Amaravati sole capital
  - Retrospective from 2 June 2024
- Schemes
  - PM Internship: age 18-25
  - Namo Drone Didi: 15,000 drones

## Economy and Climate

India slipped from 4th to 6th largest economy in nominal GDP in the IMF's World Economic Outlook 2026, behind the UK and Japan. India withdrew its bid to host COP33, which is scheduled for 2028, and it will halt HFC production clearances after 31 December 2027. Under NDC 3.0, India targets a 47 per cent cut in emission intensity from 2005 levels.

- India slipped from 4th to 6th largest economy in nominal GDP (IMF WEO 2026)
- Ranking fell behind the United Kingdom and Japan
- Reasons include GDP data revision with a new 2026 base year and rupee depreciation
- SAED is an indirect tax under Section 147 of the Finance Act, 2002
- SAED is revised every 2 weeks based on global crude prices and works as a windfall tax
- SAED revenue is not shared with states, unlike GST
- Dholera (Gujarat): first semiconductor fabrication SEZ, led by Tata Semiconductor with Taiwan's PSMC
- India withdrew its bid to host COP33 (2028) under UNFCCC
- HFC production clearances to be halted after 31 December 2027
- NDC 3.0: 47 per cent emission intensity cut from 2005 levels; 60 per cent non-fossil capacity

Mnemonic - NDC 3.0 targets: Forty-seven, Sixty, Three-and-a-half

47 = Per cent reduction in emission intensity from 2005 levels; 60 = Per cent of installed power capacity from non-fossil sources; 3.5 = Lower end, in billion tonnes CO<sub>2</sub> equivalent, of the additional carbon sink target

Mind-map outline

Economy and climate

- Economy
  - India 6th largest by nominal GDP
  - SAED revised every 2 weeks
  - Dholera semiconductor SEZ
- Climate
  - COP33 bid withdrawn
  - HFC clearances halt after 2027
  - NDC 3.0 targets

## Historical Events and Personalities

The 1526 Battle of Panipat between Babur and Ibrahim Lodi marked the foundation of the Mughal Empire in India. The section also covers the Sikh Gurus, the 1919 Jallianwala Bagh Massacre, Shaheed Diwas, and the reformers Jyotirao Phule and B. R. Ambedkar. Guru Tegh Bahadur was executed in Delhi on the orders of Aurangzeb.

- First Battle of Panipat on 21 April 1526 between Babur and Ibrahim Lodi
- Babur used the Tulughma strategy, Rumi (Ottoman) style artillery and matchlocks
- Guru Nanak Dev, first Sikh Guru, started Guru ka Langar
- Guru Arjun Dev composed the Adi Granth in 1604

- Guru Tegh Bahadur (9th Guru) founded Anandpur Sahib and was executed in Delhi on orders of Aurangzeb
- Jallianwala Bagh Massacre on 13 April 1919; official death toll 379
- Shaheed Diwas on 23 March marks the 1931 execution of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru
- Jyotirao Phule founded Satyashodhak Samaj in 1873 and opened a girls' school in Pune in 1848
- Ambedkar chaired the Drafting Committee of the Constitution and converted to Buddhism in 1956
- Ambedkar received the Bharat Ratna (posthumous, 1990)

Mnemonic - Shaheed Diwas trio: BSR: Brave Souls Resist

B = Bhagat Singh, founder of Naujawan Bharat Sabha and HSRA member, executed in 1931; S = Sukhdev Thapar, key member of Naujawan Bharat Sabha and HSRA; R = Shivaram Hari Rajguru, fired the first shot in the Saunders assassination

Mnemonic - Babur's 1526 military innovations: Turn Rumi Guns

T = Tulughma strategy: army divided into flanking units attacking from sides and rear; R = Rumi (Ottoman) artillery system: field artillery and matchlocks; G = Gunpowder warfare: first effective use of cannons and matchlocks in open-field battle in India

Mind-map outline

Historical events and personalities

- Battle of Panipat 1526
  - Babur vs Ibrahim Lodi
  - Tulughma strategy
  - Rumi artillery and matchlocks
- Sikh Gurus
  - Guru Nanak: Guru ka Langar
  - Guru Tegh Bahadur: Anandpur Sahib
  - Guru Arjun Dev: Adi Granth 1604
- Reformers and freedom struggle
  - Jallianwala Bagh 1919
  - Ambedkar: Drafting Committee chair
  - Phule: Satyashodhak Samaj 1873

## AILET Corner

### April 2026 Current Affairs: AILET Corner

#### Energy and Infrastructure

India's renewable energy progress, the revival of the Mohra hydropower plant and the Dedicated Freight Corridors form this infrastructure block. Renewables make up a large share of non-fossil capacity, and solar is the largest part of the energy mix. The Western and Eastern corridors separate freight traffic from passenger lines.

- India ranked 3rd globally in renewable energy capacity, after China and the United States
- Total installed non-fossil capacity is 283.46 GW; renewable capacity is 274.68 GW
- 55.29 GW of non-fossil capacity added in FY 2025-26
- Energy mix: Solar 54.7%, Wind 20.4%, Large Hydro 18.7%, Bioenergy 4.3%
- India achieved its 50% non-fossil power capacity target under the Paris Agreement, 5 years ahead of 2030
- Mohra Power Project is also known as Mahura Power Project and sits on the Jhelum River
- Mohra is located at Uri, Baramulla (Jammu and Kashmir) and was commissioned in 1905
- Western DFC: 1506 km, from JNPT (Maharashtra) to Dadri (Uttar Pradesh)
- Eastern DFC: 1337 km, from Ludhiana (Punjab) to Sonnagar (Bihar)
- DFC conceived in 2005, approved by Cabinet in 2008, implemented by DFCCIL

Mnemonic - Energy mix order: Sunny Winds Lift Bulbs

S = Solar, 54.7% of the energy mix; W = Wind, 20.4% of the energy mix; L = Large Hydro, 18.7% of the energy mix; B = Bioenergy, 4.3% of the energy mix

Mind-map outline

Energy and Infrastructure

- Renewable capacity
  - Rank: 3rd globally

- Non-fossil: 283.46 GW
- Renewables: 274.68 GW
- Added FY 2025-26: 55.29 GW
- Energy mix
  - Solar 54.7%
  - Wind 20.4%
  - Large Hydro 18.7%
  - Bioenergy 4.3%
- Mohra Power Project
  - Also Mahura Power Project
  - Jhelum River, Uri, Baramulla
  - Commissioned 1905
- Dedicated Freight Corridors
  - Western: 1506 km
  - Eastern: 1337 km
  - Conceived 2005, Cabinet 2008

## International Groupings and Peacekeeping

This block covers the regional and UN-linked bodies in the booklet. AZEC is a clean-energy platform for Asia, while UNIFIL is a UN force in Lebanon that patrols the Blue Line. ECOSOC and the G7 complete the section, with ECOSOC acting as a UN coordination platform and the G7 working as an informal forum without a treaty.

- AZEC was launched in 2023 on Japan's proposal as a regional platform for clean energy transition
- AZEC members: Australia, Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Japan, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam
- AZEC Plus extends the community to additional partner countries such as ASEAN and India
- UNIFIL was created by the UN Security Council in 1978 to verify Israeli withdrawal from southern Lebanon
- Blue Line: UN-demarcated boundary between Lebanon and Israel
- UNIFIL mandate: monitor ceasefire, patrol Blue Line, ensure humanitarian access, assist Lebanese Armed Forces
- ECOSOC: established 1945, one of 6 principal UN organs, 54 members, headquarters in New York
- ECOSOC: 18 members elected each year for a 3-year tenure
- India elected unopposed to four ECOSOC subsidiary bodies for 2026-2028, its 18th tenure
- G7 is an informal, non-treaty forum with no permanent secretariat; decisions taken by consensus

Mnemonic - G7 members: Using Unique Fancy Gadgets, Italians Can Jump

U = United States (first U); U = United Kingdom (second U); F = France; G = Germany; I = Italy; C = Canada; J = Japan

Mind-map outline

International Groupings

- AZEC
  - Launched 2023
  - Proposed by Japan
  - 11 member countries
- UNIFIL
  - Created by UNSC 1978
  - Patrols Blue Line
  - Verify Israeli withdrawal
- ECOSOC
  - Established 1945
  - 54 member States
  - HQ New York
- G7
  - Began as G6 in 1975
  - Canada joined 1976
  - Russia suspended 2014

## Finance, Enforcement and Cyber Cooperation

This block links banking liquidity with financial crime and cyber-fraud cooperation. The RBI's VRR auctions injected liquidity for year-end banking stability, while FIU-India and I4C work on financial and cyber frauds. The GlobE Network builds cross-border action against corruption and illicit assets.

- RBI announced a 21.25 Lakh Crore liquidity infusion through VRR auctions for year-end banking stability
- VRR is a liquidity injection tool under RBI's Liquidity Management Framework for temporary shortages
- Banks borrow short-term funds from RBI by providing government securities (G-Secs) as collateral
- VRR funds are provided through auction-based repos, with a duration of 7 to 14 days
- FIU-India: established 2004, nodal ministry is Ministry of Finance, focus on anti-money laundering
- FIU-India collects and analyses suspicious financial transaction reports and shares intelligence
- FIU-India and Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre signed an MoU to combat cyber-financial frauds
- I4C: established 2018 under Ministry of Home Affairs as central agency for cybercrime coordination
- GlobE Network: formally launched 2021, concept from Riyadh Initiative during Saudi Arabia's G20 Presidency (2020)
- GlobE operates under the UN Convention Against Corruption and aims to recover illicit assets

Mind-map outline

Finance, Enforcement, Cyber

- VRR auctions
  - 21.25 Lakh Crore infusion
  - Banks pledge G-Secs
  - Duration 7 to 14 days
- FIU-India
  - Established 2004
  - Nodal: Ministry of Finance
  - Analyses suspicious transaction reports
- I4C
  - Established 2018
  - Under Ministry of Home Affairs
  - MoU with FIU-India
- GlobE Network
  - Launched 2021
  - Recover illicit assets
  - Under UN Convention Against Corruption

## Health, Nutrition and Rankings

This block covers nutrition policy, BRICS health cooperation and higher-education rankings. Mission POSHAN 2.0 and a 15-day campaign focus on nutrition for women and children. India's 2026 BRICS Presidency includes a health working group on prevention and mental health, and QS 2026 rankings placed IIM Kozhikode in the global top 100.

- 15-day nationwide campaign aims to drive behavioural change and improve nutritional outcomes for women and children
- Mission POSHAN 2.0 was launched in 2021 to create an Integrated Nutrition Support System
- India holds the 2026 BRICS Presidency and hosted a BRICS Health Working Group meeting in New Delhi
- BRICS Mission for Healthy Lifestyles focuses on prevention of non-communicable diseases
- BRICS Mental Health and Wellness Initiative aims to strengthen mental healthcare and reduce stigma
- Integration of Traditional Medicine includes systems like AYUSH (India)
- QS World University Rankings by Subject 2026: IIM Kozhikode entered the Global Top 100
- India ranks 4th globally in total institutions ranked and new entries
- IIT Delhi leads India in Engineering and Technology in the QS rankings
- Indian institutions entered the QS Marketing rankings for the first time

## Mind-map outline

### Health, Nutrition and Rankings

- Nutrition
  - POSHAN 2.0: launched 2021
  - 15-day nationwide campaign
  - Women and children
- BRICS health
  - India holds 2026 Presidency
  - Prevent non-communicable diseases
  - Mental health and stigma reduction
  - Traditional medicine: AYUSH
- QS Rankings 2026
  - IIM Kozhikode in Global Top 100
  - India 4th in new entries
  - IIT Delhi leads engineering